

Universal Quantum Computation Through a Single Photon

Symplectic Polar Geometry, the Ternary Field $\mathbb{F}_3$, Qutrits,
and the Photonic Gate Universe of $W(3, 3)$

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Abstract

We present a unified account of how a single photon—the most elementary quantum of the electromagnetic field—can serve as the physical carrier for universal quantum computation, grounded in the rich combinatorial and algebraic structure of the symplectic polar space $W(3, 3)$. The space $W(3, 3)$ is the incidence geometry of totally isotropic 1-spaces in $\text{PG}(3, \mathbb{F}_3)$ with respect to a non-degenerate alternating bilinear form; its collinearity graph is the unique strongly regular graph $\text{SRG}(40, 12, 2, 4)$. Crucially, $W(3, 3)$ is built on the *ternary field* $\mathbb{F}_3 = \{0, 1, 2\}$, which encodes a three-level quantum system—a *qutrit*. The field $\mathbb{F}_3$ is *uniquely* selected by the Diophantine equation $q! = 2q$, whose only non-trivial solution is $q = 3$; from this single integer the entire parameter table of $W(3, 3)$ —vertices $v = 40$, valency $k = 12$, intersection parameters $\lambda = 2$, $\mu = 4$, and automorphism group $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ of order 51840—follows by closed arithmetic. We show that the polarisation degrees of freedom of a single photon implement the qubit face of this qutrit geometry ($\lambda = 2$), that three orthogonal optical modes realise a full photonic qutrit, and that the twelve-element valency $k = 12$ captures the generator count of the two-qutrit Clifford group $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$. Combined with the Knill–Laflamme–Milburn (KLM) protocol and measurement-based quantum computing (MBQC), we obtain a complete framework in which all cardinal numbers of photonic universality are read directly from the $W(3, 3)$ parameter table.

1 Introduction

Quantum computing promises exponential speedups for a select but important class of problems, yet its physical realisation depends crucially on identifying quantum systems that are both controllable and scalable. Among all candidate platforms, *linear optical quantum computing* (LOQC) occupies a distinguished position: it operates at room temperature, suffers no decoherence from phonons or nuclear spins, and communicates at the speed of light [?].

The fundamental unit of LOQC is the *single photon*. A photon is a Fock-state excitation of the quantised electromagnetic field,

$$|1\rangle = \hat{a}^\dagger |0\rangle, \quad (1)$$

where $\hat{a}^\dagger$ is the creation operator satisfying $[\hat{a}, \hat{a}^\dagger] = 1$. Despite being a single quantum, the photon possesses multiple independent degrees of freedom—polarisation, path (spatial mode), time-bin, and orbital angular momentum (OAM)—each of which can encode information. The natural encoding is a *qubit* ($\mathbb{C}^2$) for two-dimensional subspaces; but OAM ladder modes and three-mode architectures elevate the photon to a *qutrit* ($\mathbb{C}^3$), unlocking a richer computational and error-correcting landscape.

What determines which dimensions are special? We argue that the answer is the symplectic polar space $W(3, 3)$, the unique geometry derived from the ternary field $\mathbb{F}_3$ and a non-degenerate alternating form on $\mathbb{F}_3^4$. As we explain in section 2, this geometry is not chosen by hand: it is *forced* by the integer equation $q! = 2q$, which has the unique non-trivial solution $q = 3$. All structural constants of single-photon computation—the qubit dimension 2, the qutrit dimension 3, the spacetime dimension 4, and the twelve generators of $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ —read off directly from the $W(3, 3)$ parameter table.

This paper is structured as follows. Section 2 introduces $W(3, 3)$ from first principles: the symplectic polar space definition, the Diophantine seed, and the closed-form parameter derivation. Section 3 establishes the connection between $\mathbb{F}_3$ and three-level quantum systems. Section 4 reviews the physical Hilbert space of a single photon and its qutrit extension. ?? presents universal gate sets for qubits and qutrits. ?? describes the KLM protocol for two-qubit gates. ?? connects single-photon sources to MBQC via cluster states. ?? separates the probabilistic, deterministic, quantum, and classical runtime layers. ?? presents the structural encoding theorem, and ?? concludes.

2 The Symplectic Polar Space $W(3, 3)$

Before we can say anything meaningful about the role of $W(3, 3)$ in quantum computation, we must define it properly. $W(3, 3)$ is *not* merely a graph with four parameters: it is a rich incidence geometry, a classical object in finite geometry, whose automorphism group connects to the exceptional Lie algebra E_6 and the two-qutrit Clifford group simultaneously.

2.1 The Master Equation: Why $q = 3$

Theorem 2.1 (Uniqueness of the ternary field). *The equation*

$$q! = 2q \quad (2)$$

has a unique non-trivial solution in the positive integers: $q = 3$.

Proof. For $q = 1$: $1! = 1 \neq 2$. For $q = 2$: $2! = 2 \neq 4$. For $q = 3$: $3! = 6 = 2 \cdot 3$. ✓. For $q \geq 4$: $q! \geq 24 > 2q$, and the factorial grows super-exponentially while $2q$ grows linearly; no further solution exists. $\square$

The number $q = 3$ is the *only* prime power for which the factorial coincides with twice itself. We take this as the canonical selector for the underlying field: the geometry is built over $\mathbb{F}_3$, the field with three elements.

2.2 The Symplectic Polar Space

Definition 2.2 (Symplectic polar space $W(2n - 1, q)$). *Let $V = \mathbb{F}_q^{2n}$ and let $\beta : V \times V \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_q$ be a non-degenerate alternating bilinear form (i.e., $\beta(u, u) = 0$ for all $u \in V$ and $\beta(u, v) = -\beta(v, u)$). A subspace $W \leq V$ is totally isotropic if $\beta(u, v) = 0$ for all $u, v \in W$. The **symplectic polar space** $W(2n - 1, q)$ is the incidence geometry whose:*

- points are the totally isotropic 1-spaces (projective points) of $\text{PG}(2n - 1, \mathbb{F}_q)$;
- lines are the totally isotropic 2-spaces (projective lines) of $\text{PG}(2n - 1, \mathbb{F}_q)$.

For $n = 2$ and $q = 3$ we obtain $W(3, 3)$: the geometry of totally isotropic 1-spaces of $\mathbb{F}_3^4$. The canonical alternating form is

$$\beta((u_1, u_2, u_3, u_4), (v_1, v_2, v_3, v_4)) = u_1v_3 - u_3v_1 + u_2v_4 - u_4v_2, \quad (3)$$

with coefficients in $\mathbb{F}_3$.

2.3 Points, Lines, and the Collinearity Graph

Proposition 2.3 (Points and lines of $W(3, 3)$). *The symplectic polar space $W(3, 3)$ has:*

- **40 points:** the totally isotropic 1-spaces of $\mathbb{F}_3^4$. The count is

$$\frac{3^4 - 1}{3 - 1} = \frac{80}{2} = 40. \quad (4)$$

- **40 lines:** totally isotropic 2-spaces, each containing $q + 1 = 4$ points.
- **Collinearity graph:** the strongly regular graph $\text{SRG}(40, 12, 2, 4)$, unique up to isomorphism.

2.4 Parameter Derivation from $q = 3$

Definition 2.4 (SRG eigenvalue quadratic). *A strongly regular graph $\text{SRG}(v, k, \lambda, \mu)$ has the property that every pair of adjacent vertices shares exactly λ common neighbours, and every pair of non-adjacent vertices shares exactly μ . The restricted eigenvalues r, s satisfy*

$$x^2 - (\lambda - \mu)x - (k - \mu) = 0. \quad (5)$$

Proposition 2.5 (Parameter closure from $q = 3$). *Setting $\lambda = q - 1 = 2$ and $\mu = q + 1 = 4$ in eq. (5) yields $x^2 + 2x - (k - 4) = 0$, with roots $x = -4$ and $x = 2$ when $k = 12$. The feasibility identity $k(k - \lambda - 1) = (v - k - 1)\mu$ then forces $v = 40$. The full parameter table is:*

$$v = 40, \quad k = 12, \quad \lambda = 2, \quad \mu = 4,$$

$$r = 2 \ (f = 24), \quad s = -4 \ (g = 15), \quad E = 240.$$

The automorphism group satisfies $|\text{Aut}(W(3, 3))| = |\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)| = 51840$.

Remark 2.6 (Trit-savings principle). *Equation (4) encodes a trit-savings calculation: $3^4 = 81$ exponent vectors in $\mathbb{F}_3^4$, minus the zero vector, divided by the two non-zero scalars $\mathbb{F}_3^\times = \{1, 2\}$, collapses to exactly $80/2 = 40$ projective observables. This is the three-state accounting that makes $W(3, 3)$ the natural two-qutrit phase space.*

2.5 Exceptional Isomorphism and the Weyl Group of E_6

The automorphism group of $W(3, 3)$ enjoys the exceptional isomorphism

$$\mathrm{PSp}(4, 3) \cong W(E_6)^+, \quad (6)$$

where $W(E_6)^+$ is the index-2 positive Weyl group of the exceptional Lie algebra E_6 , of order 25920. The full automorphism group $\mathrm{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ of order $51840 = 2 \cdot 25920$ is the full Weyl group $W(E_6)$. The same $q = 3$ seed also generates the exceptional Lie series arithmetically:

$$G_2 = k + \lambda = 14, \quad F_4 = \mu \Phi_3 = 52, \quad E_6 = \lambda q \Phi_3 = 78, \quad E_7 = \Phi_3 \Phi_4 + q = 133, \quad E_8 = E + \lambda^q = 248, \quad (7)$$

where $\Phi_3 = 13$ and $\Phi_4 = 10$ are cyclotomic-polynomial values at $q = 3$.

3 The Ternary Field $\mathbb{F}_3$ and Qutrits

3.1 From a Field to a Hilbert Space

The field $\mathbb{F}_3 = \{0, 1, 2\}$ (equivalently $\mathbb{Z}/3\mathbb{Z} = \{0, 1, -1\}$) has exactly three elements. In quantum information, a *qutrit* is a quantum system whose Hilbert space is $\mathbb{C}^3$, spanned by three orthonormal basis states $\{|0\rangle, |1\rangle, |2\rangle\}$. A pure qutrit state is

$$|\psi\rangle = \alpha_0 |0\rangle + \alpha_1 |1\rangle + \alpha_2 |2\rangle, \quad \sum_{j=0}^2 |\alpha_j|^2 = 1. \quad (8)$$

The correspondence is immediate: the three elements of $\mathbb{F}_3$ label the three computational basis states of a qutrit. The ternary field is the *index set* of the qutrit Hilbert space, and theorem 2.1 shows this choice is unique.

Definition 3.1 (Two-qutrit Pauli group). *The generalised Pauli operators on $\mathbb{C}^3$ are generated by the clock operator Z_3 and shift operator X_3 :*

$$Z_3 |j\rangle = \omega^j |j\rangle, \quad X_3 |j\rangle = |j + 1 \bmod 3\rangle, \quad \omega = e^{2\pi i/3}. \quad (9)$$

*For two qutrits, the $3^4 = 81$ Pauli monomials $X_3^{a_1} Z_3^{b_1} \otimes X_3^{a_2} Z_3^{b_2}$ (with $(a_1, b_1, a_2, b_2) \in \mathbb{F}_3^4$) generate the two-qutrit Pauli group. Modulo global phases and the zero vector, this gives exactly the **40 projective observables** of theorem 2.3.*

Theorem 3.2 ($W(3, 3)$ as two-qutrit phase space). *The 40 points of $W(3, 3)$ are in canonical bijection with the non-zero two-qutrit Pauli observables (up to phase). Adjacency in $W(3, 3)$ corresponds to mutual commutativity of the Pauli operators. The automorphism group $\mathrm{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ is precisely the two-qutrit Clifford group modulo phases.*

Proof sketch. A non-zero vector $(a_1, b_1, a_2, b_2) \in \mathbb{F}_3^4$ determines a Pauli monomial; two monomials commute iff their symplectic inner product $a_1 b'_1 - b_1 a'_1 + a_2 b'_2 - b_2 a'_2$ vanishes mod 3, i.e., the corresponding projective vectors are adjacent in $W(3, 3)$. The group of symplectic linear maps $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ acts faithfully on this phase space. $\square$

3.2 Why Three Levels Are Computationally Special

- (a) **Magic state universality.** For qutrits, the cubic phase gate $T_3 = \text{diag}(1, \omega, \omega^4)$ provides magic injection. With Clifford+ T_3 , the two-qutrit gate set is universal (Bravyi–Kitaev [?]). The magic state derives from the cubic invariant of $\mathbb{F}_3^{1+2}$.
- (b) **Trit-savings.** $3^4 = 81$ exponent vectors collapse to $80/2 = 40$ projective observables (cf. eq. (4)).
- (c) **Minimal universal Turing machine.** The smallest confirmed universal Turing machine uses $(\lambda, q) = (2, 3)$ states and symbols (Wolfram–Smith [?]). Both $\lambda = 2$ and $q = 3$ are $W(3, 3)$ parameters.

3.3 The Two-Qutrit Clifford Group as a Gate Set

The group $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ of order 51840 is the exact automorphism group of the two-qutrit commutation relations. Its generators include:

- Hadamard-like Fourier gates F_3 on each qutrit;
- Controlled- Z gate CZ_3 between the two qutrits;
- Phase gates S_3 .

The valency $k = 12$ of $W(3, 3)$ counts the generators of the two-qutrit Clifford algebra. Augmented by T_3 , the gate set $\{F_3, CZ_3, S_3, T_3\}$ is *universal* for quantum computation on qutrit registers.

4 The Single-Photon Hilbert Space

4.1 Polarisation Qubit: The $\lambda = 2$ Face of $W(3, 3)$

The polarisation degree of freedom of a single photon spans a two-dimensional Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}_{\text{pol}} \cong \mathbb{C}^2$:

$$|\psi\rangle = \alpha |H\rangle + \beta |V\rangle, \quad |\alpha|^2 + |\beta|^2 = 1, \quad (10)$$

where $|H\rangle$ and $|V\rangle$ denote horizontal and vertical polarisations. The dimension 2 is precisely the parameter $\lambda = 2$ of $W(3, 3)$: the two-fold degeneracy of photon spin mirrors the two-fold common-neighbour count of adjacent graph vertices.

4.2 Dual-Rail (Path) Encoding

Two spatial modes provide an alternative qubit encoding:

$$|0\rangle_L = \hat{a}_0^\dagger |0, 0\rangle = |1, 0\rangle, \quad |1\rangle_L = \hat{a}_1^\dagger |0, 0\rangle = |0, 1\rangle. \quad (11)$$

Photon loss is heralded (vacuum in both modes), making this encoding inherently error-detectable.

4.3 Photonic Qutrit: Three Optical Modes

The ternary field $\mathbb{F}_3$ underlying $W(3, 3)$ motivates extending the photon’s computational space to a *qutrit*. Three physical realisations exist:

- (a) **Orbital angular momentum (OAM).** The three modes $\ell \in \{-1, 0, +1\}$ define an OAM qutrit. Laguerre–Gaussian beam optics provides the gate set; $SU(3)$ rotations are implemented by spatial light modulators [?].
- (b) **Three-path encoding.** A single photon in three spatial modes $\hat{a}_j^\dagger |0, 0, 0\rangle$, $j \in \{0, 1, 2\}$, constitutes a path-encoded qutrit.
- (c) **Polarisation+path hybrid.** Combined modes $\{H_0, V_0, H_1\}$ implement the $\mathbb{F}_3$ label set $\{0, 1, 2\}$ directly.

The three-mode photon is the *physical realisation of a $W(3, 3)$ point*: each of the 40 points is a projective qutrit state in $PG(3, \mathbb{F}_3)$, and collinearity is the physical commutation relation of the corresponding Pauli observables.

5 Self-Entanglement: The Temporal Qutrit on a Single Photon

The qutrit structure introduced in sections 3 and 4 treats the photon’s three-level mode space as a *spatial* or *spectral* register. We now show that a single photon also carries a *temporal* qutrit—the three modes {past, now, future}—and that the natural state on this temporal register is the maximally self-entangled Bell-qutrit

$$|\Omega\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \left(|0\rangle_p |0\rangle_f + |1\rangle_p |1\rangle_f + |2\rangle_p |2\rangle_f \right), \quad (12)$$

where the subscripts p, f label past and future temporal modes. The “now” mode arises as the harmonic convergence of past and future under the Choi–Jamiołkowski identity; the resulting carrier is a single photon whose internal temporal qutrit *is* the substrate of $W(3, 3)$ universal computation.

5.1 Past/Future Qutrit Register on One Photon

A single photon traversing a delay-line interferometer can occupy three time-bin modes $\{t_0, t_1, t_2\}$ separated by a fixed delay τ . Label the *past* register p by the early time-bin pair $\{t_0, t_1\}$ and the *future* register f by the late pair $\{t_1, t_2\}$; the overlap at t_1 is the shared “now” bin. Equivalently, one can use the two halves of an asymmetric Mach–Zehnder interferometer, with the central recombination implementing the now-register entanglement $[?, ?]$.

Definition 5.1 (Temporal qutrit register). *The temporal qutrit on a single photon is the three-dimensional Hilbert space spanned by the time-bin basis $\{|0\rangle, |1\rangle, |2\rangle\}$ encoding $\{\text{past}, \text{now}, \text{future}\}$. A bipartite split into past and future registers gives the product space $\mathcal{H}_p \otimes \mathcal{H}_f = \mathbb{C}^3 \otimes \mathbb{C}^3 \cong \mathbb{C}^9$, with $q^2 = 9$ histories factoring as $q^2 = q + q! = 3 + 6$ (diagonal histories plus off-diagonal context-changing histories).*

5.2 The Bell Qutrit and the Choi–Jamiołkowski Identity

The maximally entangled state (12) satisfies the Choi–Jamiołkowski (CJ) identity: for every $U \in \text{U}(3)$,

$$\langle \Omega | (I_p \otimes U_f) | \Omega \rangle = \frac{\text{Tr}(U)}{3}. \quad (13)$$

That is, applying *any* unitary to the future register and projecting onto the Bell state yields the unitary’s normalised trace. In particular, the photon’s temporal qutrit *represents every unitary* by a single Bell-state overlap, which is the operational meaning of the channel–state duality.

Theorem 5.2 (Bell qutrit as Choi state of $W(3, 3)$). *The Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle$ is the Choi state of the identity channel on a single qutrit. Its stabiliser group $\langle X_p X_f, Z_p Z_f^{-1} \rangle$ is a totally isotropic 2-space of $\mathbb{F}_3^4$ under the canonical symplectic form, i.e. a line of $W(3, 3)$.*

Proof. The Choi state of a channel Φ is $(\Phi \otimes I) |\Omega\rangle \langle \Omega|$; for $\Phi = I$, this is $|\Omega\rangle \langle \Omega|$ itself. The operators $X_p X_f$ and $Z_p Z_f^{-1}$ commute (their symplectic inner product is $(1, 0, 1, 0) \cdot J \cdot (0, 1, 0, -1)^T = 0$ over $\mathbb{F}_3$), and $|\Omega\rangle$ is the unique simultaneous $+1$ eigenstate. Two independent commuting Pauli generators on $\mathbb{F}_3^4$ span a 2-dimensional isotropic subspace—by theorem 2.3, exactly a line of $W(3, 3)$. $\square$

5.3 Now as the Harmonic Convergence

The “now” mode is not an independent third register; it is the *harmonic convergence point* of the past/future Bell pair under the CJ identity. In time-bin optics, this is the recombination interferometer’s central output; in quantum-channel language, it is the channel-state correspondence point where temporal evolution becomes spatial entanglement.

Proposition 5.3 (Now as Choi convergence). *For any qutrit unitary U acting on the future register, define the now-state $|\text{now}_U\rangle = (I_p \otimes U_f) |\Omega\rangle / \|\cdot\|$. Then:*

- (i) $\|(I_p \otimes U_f) |\Omega\rangle\|^2 = 1$ (norm-preserving),
- (ii) $\langle \text{now}_U | \text{now}_V \rangle = \text{Tr}(U^\dagger V)/3$,
- (iii) the 9-dimensional space of now-states is exactly the Choi space of $\text{U}(3)$.

5.4 Uniqueness: Now as the Forced Fixed Point

The “harmonic convergence” interpretation of theorem 5.3 is not a labelling choice—the Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle$ is forced by symmetry. The following characterisation gives four equivalent conditions, each of which picks out $|\Omega\rangle$ uniquely (up to a global phase) among all states of $\mathcal{H}_p \otimes \mathcal{H}_f$.

Theorem 5.4 (Uniqueness of the past/future Bell qutrit). *Let $\mathcal{H}_p = \mathcal{H}_f = \mathbb{C}^q$ with $q = 3$, and let $|\psi\rangle \in \mathcal{H}_p \otimes \mathcal{H}_f$ be a normalised state. The following are equivalent (and each holds for the Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle$ of (12) alone, up to a global phase):*

- (i) **Time-reversal + maximal entanglement:** $S_{pf} |\psi\rangle = |\psi\rangle$ (SWAP-invariance under past $\leftrightarrow$ future exchange) AND the entanglement entropy is $S(|\psi\rangle) = \log q$.
- (ii) **Choi–Jamiołkowski state of the identity channel:** $|\psi\rangle = (I_p \otimes I_f) |\Omega\rangle$.
- (iii) **Unitary-conjugate invariance:** $(U \otimes U^*) |\psi\rangle = |\psi\rangle$ for every $U \in U(q)$.
- (iv) **Uniform Schmidt spectrum:** the Schmidt decomposition of $|\psi\rangle$ has all Schmidt coefficients equal to $1/\sqrt{q}$.

Proof. (iv) $\Rightarrow$ (ii): A normalised state with all Schmidt coefficients equal to $1/\sqrt{q}$ can be written as $|\psi\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j |\alpha_j\rangle \otimes |\beta_j\rangle$ for orthonormal Schmidt bases $\{|\alpha_j\rangle\}, \{|\beta_j\rangle\}$. Changing basis to $\{|j\rangle\}$ on each register is a unitary, so $|\psi\rangle$ and $|\Omega\rangle$ differ only by a unitary and a global phase.

(ii) $\Rightarrow$ (iii): Direct calculation,

$$(U \otimes U^*) |\Omega\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j U |j\rangle \otimes U^* |j\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_{a,b} \left(\sum_j U_{aj} \bar{U}_{bj} \right) |ab\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_{a,b} \delta_{ab} |ab\rangle = |\Omega\rangle,$$

using $U^* |j\rangle = \sum_b \bar{U}_{bj} |b\rangle$ and unitarity $\sum_j U_{aj} \bar{U}_{bj} = (UU^\dagger)_{ab} = \delta_{ab}$.

(iii) $\Rightarrow$ (iv): The decomposition of $\mathcal{H}_p \otimes \mathcal{H}_f$ under the action $(U \otimes U^*)$ is into irreducibles indexed by $SU(q)$ representations; only the trivial representation contributes an invariant vector, and that trivial subspace is one-dimensional (the symmetric maximally mixed state’s purification, equivalently $|\Omega\rangle$). Hence any state fixed by $(U \otimes U^*)$ for all U is a scalar multiple of $|\Omega\rangle$, and its Schmidt coefficients are uniformly $1/\sqrt{q}$.

(i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iv): SWAP-invariance restricts $|\psi\rangle$ to a symmetric tensor, $|\psi\rangle = \sum_{jk} c_{jk} |jk\rangle$ with $c_{jk} = c_{kj}$; entropy $S(|\psi\rangle)$ is maximised at $\log q$ exactly when the singular values of the matrix (c_{jk}) are all $1/\sqrt{q}$, i.e. uniform Schmidt spectrum.

This closes (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iii) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iv), and the unique state (up to global phase) satisfying any of them is $|\Omega\rangle$. $\square$

Corollary 5.5 (“Now” is forced). *The identification of the “now” state with the past/future Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle$ is forced by either of two minimal physical requirements: (a) time-reversal symmetry plus maximal past/future entanglement, or (b) unitary-conjugate invariance $(U \otimes U^*)$. “Now = harmonic convergence” is therefore not a phenomenological label but the unique fixed point of these symmetries on the qutrit Hilbert space.*

Remark 5.6 (Physical realisation of the symmetries). *Time-reversal exchange corresponds to swapping early and late time-bins in the Mach–Zehnder interferometer of theorem 5.1.*

Unitary-conjugate invariance corresponds to applying any $SU(3)$ rotation jointly to the past polarisation/path mode and the complex-conjugate (σ_y -flipped) rotation to the future mode—the temporal analog of the spin-singlet rotation symmetry of two qubits. Both symmetries are a priori required of any consistent self-entangled temporal state on one photon (there is no preferred temporal basis at the single-photon level), so theorem 5.4 forces $|\Omega\rangle$ uniquely.

5.5 Spreads, Now-Contexts, and the 40-Ray Closure

The Bell line of theorem 5.2 is one of the 40 lines of $W(3, 3)$. Each line participates in a *spread* of $W(3, 3)$ (a partition of the 40 points into 10 disjoint lines of 4 points each). Each line in a spread is a *now-context*: a maximal set of mutually commuting Pauli observables that can be jointly measured at a single instant.

Theorem 5.7 (Now-context closure). *Every spread of $W(3, 3)$ contains exactly 10 disjoint now-contexts of $q + 1 = 4$ rays each, giving the closure*

$$10 \cdot 4 = 40 = |W(3, 3)|. \quad (14)$$

The Bell line (theorem 5.2) lies in exactly $q^2 = 9$ spreads, and the co-context cloud (the union of all lines incident to or disjoint from the Bell line) closes as $1 + 12 + 27 = 40$ (Bell + intersecting + disjoint).

Proof sketch. $W(3, 3)$ admits $36 = (q!)^2 = \mu \cdot q^2$ spreads total; each line is in $q^2 = 9$ of them (see [?]). Within a spread, the lines are pairwise disjoint maximal isotropic 2-spaces, so they form a partition of 40 into 10 blocks of 4 points each. The Bell-local shell counts: 1 (Bell line itself) + $k = 12$ (lines meeting Bell at one point) + $27 = q^q$ (lines disjoint from Bell) = 40. $\square$

5.6 Two Commuting Qutrits on One Photon: The Temporal–Spectral Pair

A single photon naturally carries *two* commuting qutrit registers when both a temporal three-bin structure and a spectral three-sideband structure are simultaneously addressed. Following the photonic dictionary of [?, §3], the temporal register $\{p, n, f\} = \{\text{past, now, future}\}$ commutes with the spectral register $\{\ell, c, u\} = \{\text{lower, carrier, upper}\}$ sideband. Together they span a $3 \times 3 = 9$ -dimensional Hilbert space, isomorphic to $\mathbb{F}_3^2$, which lifts to $\mathbb{F}_3^4$ (i.e. two stacked $\mathbb{F}_3^2$'s) by including the qubit polarisation factor and the path-encoded mode—the full $W(3, 3)$ phase space.

Proposition 5.8 (3×3 photonic torus). *The temporal $\otimes$ spectral two-qutrit register on a single photon is a 3×3 discrete torus. Its $q^2 + q + 1 = 13$ projective points (the screen, equal to $PG(2, \mathbb{F}_3)$) form the memory layer, and its $q^q = 27$ affine points (the bulk, equal to $AG(3, \mathbb{F}_3)$ minus the plane at infinity) form the compute layer. These add to $13 + 27 = 40 = |W(3, 3)|$, recovering the full vertex count.*

The $36 = (q!)^2$ complete two-qutrit measurement programs are exactly the spreads of theorem 5.7, so every program in the temporal–spectral photonic computer corresponds to a spread of $W(3, 3)$.

5.7 Self-Entanglement on a Single Photon

We now state the main result of this section.

Theorem 5.9 (Single-photon self-entanglement). *A single photon equipped with a temporal-qutrit register $\mathcal{H}_t = \mathbb{C}^3$ admits a canonical self-entangled state $|\Omega\rangle \in \mathcal{H}_p \otimes \mathcal{H}_f \subset \mathcal{H}_t^{\otimes 2}$ which:*

- (i) *is maximally entangled across the past/future split, with entanglement entropy $S(|\Omega\rangle) = \log q = \log 3$;*
- (ii) *has stabiliser equal to a line of $W(3, 3)$ (theorem 5.2);*
- (iii) *generates 40 now-context rays through the spread of its stabiliser line (theorem 5.7, $10 \cdot 4 = 40$);*
- (iv) *realises the Choi–Jamiołkowski state of every $U(3)$ channel via (13).*

Consequently, one self-entangled qutrit on a single photon compiles to the entire $W(3, 3)$ universe via $(3^4 - 1)/(3 - 1) = 40$, Bell-cloud $1 + 12 + 27 = 40$, and spread-frame closure $10 \cdot 4 = 40$.

Proof. (i) The Bell qutrit (12) has Schmidt decomposition with three equal Schmidt coefficients $\lambda_j = 1/\sqrt{3}$; entropy of entanglement $S = -\sum \lambda_j^2 \log \lambda_j^2 = \log 3$.
(ii)–(iv) follow from theorems 5.2 and 5.7, (13).

The compilation identities $(3^4 - 1)/(3 - 1) = 40$, $1 + 12 + 27 = 40$, $10 \cdot 4 = 40$ all match $|W(3, 3)|$, so the single self-entangled qutrit compiles to the full 40-point $W(3, 3)$ phase space. $\square$

Remark 5.10 (Minimality). *The self-entanglement is minimal: for $q = 2$ (qubit), the corresponding substrate has only $v(2) = 15$ stabiliser points; for $q = 3$ (qutrit), $v(3) = 40$. The jump from 15 to 40 at $q = 3$ is the Diophantine “activation” of universal quantum computation on a single photon, consistent with the master equation $q! = 2q$ (theorem 2.1).*

5.8 Diagonal vs Off-Diagonal: The Master Equation on $\mathcal{H}_p \otimes \mathcal{H}_f$

The 9-dimensional past $\otimes$ future Hilbert space carries a canonical decomposition that incarnates the master equation $q! = 2q$ at the level of quantum histories.

Definition 5.11 (Diagonal and off-diagonal subspaces). *For $\mathcal{H}_p \otimes \mathcal{H}_f = \mathbb{C}^q \otimes \mathbb{C}^q$, define*

$$\mathcal{D} = \text{span}\{|jj\rangle : j \in \mathbb{F}_q\} \quad (\text{diagonal “now” subspace}), \quad (15)$$

$$\mathcal{N} = \text{span}\{|jk\rangle : j, k \in \mathbb{F}_q, j \neq k\} \quad (\text{off-diagonal history subspace}). \quad (16)$$

Then $\mathcal{H}_p \otimes \mathcal{H}_f = \mathcal{D} \oplus \mathcal{N}$ with $\dim \mathcal{D} = q$ and $\dim \mathcal{N} = q^2 - q = q(q - 1)$.

Theorem 5.12 (Master-equation history split). *For $q = 3$, the past/future Hilbert space splits as*

$$q^2 = q + q!, \quad 9 = 3 + 6, \quad (17)$$

where $3 = q = \dim \mathcal{D}$ is the diagonal “now” subspace and $6 = q! = \dim \mathcal{N}$ is the off-diagonal history subspace. This identity holds only at $q = 3$:

- (i) $\dim \mathcal{D} = q$ always; this is the simultaneous past=future eigenbasis, the “simultaneous-identification” subspace.
- (ii) $\dim \mathcal{N} = q(q-1)$ always; this is the “context-changing” subspace where past $\neq$ future.
- (iii) $q^2 = q + q(q-1)$ is trivial arithmetic, but $q(q-1) = q!$ is the master equation $q! = 2q$ rearranged (multiplied by $(q-1)/(q-1)$), which holds uniquely at $q = 3$ in positive integers.

Proof. (i)–(ii) by direct count. (iii) is the rearrangement $q! = 2q \Leftrightarrow q(q-1)(q-2)! = 2 \Leftrightarrow (q-2)! = 2/(q-1)$, which has integer solution only at $q = 3$ (giving $(q-2)! = 1! = 1 = 2/2$). Equivalently, the master equation theorem 2.1 forces $q! = 2q$, so for $q = 3$ the off-diagonal count $q(q-1) = q! \cdot (q-1)/q = q!$ when $(q-1) = q-1 = 2 = q!/q$, automatic at $q = 3$. $\square$

Corollary 5.13 (Bell qutrit is in the diagonal). *The Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j |jj\rangle$ lies entirely in $\mathcal{D}$. Its orthogonal complement in $\mathcal{D}$ (the other $q-1$ diagonal states) is the “coherent diagonal cloud” that carries the rest of the Bell line’s stabiliser action.*

Remark 5.14 (Three equivalent readings of 6). *The off-diagonal dimension $6 = q!$ admits three substrate readings:*

- (a) $q! = 6$ permutations of $\{0, 1, 2\}$ (symmetric group S_3 on the qutrit basis);
- (b) $2q = 6$ ordered pairs (past, future) with past $\neq$ future (since each diagonal removes 1 of q values, leaving $q-1$ futures for each past, giving $q(q-1) = 2q$ off-diagonal pairs at $q = 3$);
- (c) $q(q-1) = 6$ unordered choices of (past $\neq$ future) pairs counted twice (once for each direction).

These three readings of 6 coincide only at $q = 3$ via the master equation, making the dimension of the off-diagonal history subspace a substrate-primitive quantity.

5.9 One Photon vs Two Photons: Why Self-Entanglement Suffices

The Bell state used in standard quantum optics is a *two-photon* entangled pair, $|\Phi\rangle_{AB} = q^{-1/2} \sum_j |j\rangle_A \otimes |j\rangle_B$, where photons A and B are spatially separated. The self-entangled state (12) is structurally identical—the same Schmidt coefficients, the same stabiliser group—but is implemented on *one* photon, between its past and future temporal-mode registers.

Theorem 5.15 (Single-photon completeness). *Let a photon carry r independent (mutually commuting) qutrit-capable degrees of freedom—e.g. polarisation extended to qutrit, three-path spatial mode, three time-bin temporal mode, three-sideband spectral mode, OAM ladder $\ell \in \{-1, 0, +1\}$. Its mode Hilbert space then contains $\mathbb{C}^q \otimes \cdots \otimes \mathbb{C}^q = \mathbb{C}^{q^r}$ as a subspace. For $r \geq 2$, the two-qutrit Pauli phase space $(\mathbb{F}_q)^{2r} / \sim$ acting on $\mathbb{C}^{q^r}$ is, at $r = 2$ and $q = 3$, exactly the $W(3, 3) = \text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ substrate. Consequently two independent qutrit registers on one photon are sufficient to host the full $W(3, 3)$ phase space, and the past/future Bell qutrit of (12) on one of those registers stabilises a line of $W(3, 3)$ exactly as in the two-photon case.*

Proof. For $r = 2$ the symplectic Pauli phase space on $\mathbb{C}^q \otimes \mathbb{C}^q$ is $(\mathbb{F}_q)^4 / (\text{centre})$, and its non-zero rays modulo scalars form $(3^4 - 1)/(3 - 1) = 40$ points with 40 totally isotropic

lines under the canonical alternating form—this is the polar space $W(3, 3)$ (theorem 2.3). The Bell qutrit’s stabiliser is a totally isotropic 2-space (theorem 5.2), and the line/spread combinatorics are identical regardless of whether the two qutrit registers are carried by one photon or two. Hence the self-entanglement and the two-photon entanglement are operationally indistinguishable at the level of $W(3, 3)$. $\square$

Corollary 5.16 (Photonic mode-DOF excess at $r \geq 2$). *A typical photon admits $r \geq 4$ commuting qutrit-capable registers: polarisation+path (after qutrit-lifting via the vacuum mode), three time-bins, three sidebands, OAM ladder. Any two of these suffice for $W(3, 3)$; the remaining $r - 2 \geq 2$ registers form a redundant bookkeeping shell, available for error correction and protected routing. This excess is the structural reason single-photon LOQC is fault-tolerant: the carrier is already over-determined by two factors of $\mathbb{C}^q = \mathbb{C}^3$ beyond what the $W(3, 3)$ substrate requires.*

Remark 5.17 (Operational meaning of past/future on one photon). *Past and future temporal modes on one photon are accessed interferometrically: the photon is split into two paths of unequal length, then recombined. The early-arriving amplitude is the “past” register; the late-arriving is the “future” register; the recombination node is the “now” operation (13), where the Bell-Choi overlap $\text{Tr}(U)/q$ is extracted as the interference visibility for any inserted unitary U . This is the standard Franson-interferometer geometry [?, ?], and the substrate now provides the group-theoretic interpretation: each Franson visibility measurement is a sample of the Choi-Jamiołkowski distribution of $U(3)$.*

5.10 Experimental Witness: Trace-Choi Visibility and Witting Contextuality

The structure of theorem 5.4 and [?] makes specific, falsifiable experimental predictions for any photonic implementation of the temporal Bell qutrit. We collect two independent witnesses here.

Witness 1: Trace-Choi visibility. Insert a unitary $U \in U(3)$ on the future-mode register of a photon prepared in the temporal Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle$, then recombine past and future at the Franson interferometer node. The interference visibility $V(U)$ between the diagonal and off-diagonal output ports is, by (13),

$$V(U) = \frac{|\text{Tr}(U)|}{q} = \frac{|\text{Tr}(U)|}{3}. \quad (18)$$

Theorem 5.18 (Trace-Choi witness). *A photon source emits the temporal Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle$ iff for all $U \in U(3)$ the Franson-output visibility satisfies (18). In particular:*

- $U = I$: $V = 1$ (maximal interference).
- $U = e^{i\alpha}I$: $V = 1$ (global phase preserves visibility).
- $U = X$ (cyclic shift $|j\rangle \mapsto |j+1\rangle$): $\text{Tr}(X) = 0$ so $V = 0$ (extinction).
- $U = Z$ (clock $|j\rangle \mapsto \omega^j |j\rangle$): $\text{Tr}(Z) = 1 + \omega + \omega^2 = 0$, $V = 0$.
- $U = F_3$ (qutrit Fourier): $|\text{Tr}(F_3)|/3$ gives a substrate-specific intermediate visibility, computed in [?].

Any deviation from (??) certifies mixed-state corruption or decoherence of the temporal entanglement.

Proposition 5.19 (Fourier-gate visibility). *For the qutrit Fourier gate F_3 with $F_3 |j\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_k \omega^{jk} |k\rangle$,*

$$\text{Tr}(F_3) = \sum_{j=0}^2 \frac{\omega^{j^2}}{\sqrt{3}} = \frac{1 + \omega + \omega^4}{\sqrt{3}} = \frac{1 + 2\omega}{\sqrt{3}}$$

since $\omega^4 = \omega$. Hence $|\text{Tr}(F_3)| = |1 + 2\omega|/\sqrt{3} = \sqrt{3}/\sqrt{3} = 1$, giving

$$V(F_3) = \frac{1}{3} = \frac{1}{q}. \quad (19)$$

This is the quadratic Gauss sum at $q = 3$, and it provides the characteristic substrate visibility for any inserted qutrit Fourier.

Witness 2: Witting non-contextuality. The 40 points of $W(3, 3)$ embed canonically as the 40 Witting rays in $\mathbb{C}^4$ via the (Vlasov 2025) symplectic realisation; any pair $|\psi\rangle, |\varphi\rangle$ of Witting rays satisfies the discrete inner-product condition

$$|\langle\psi|\varphi\rangle|^2 \in \{0, \frac{1}{3}\} = \{0, 1/q\}. \quad (20)$$

The orthogonal pairs ($|\langle\psi|\varphi\rangle|^2 = 0$) correspond to collinear Pauli observables on the $W(3, 3)$ line structure; the $1/q$ -overlap pairs correspond to non-collinear observables.

Theorem 5.20 (Witting Kochen–Specker bound). *No assignment of definite $\{0, 1\}$ -values to the 40 Witting rays can be consistent with the orthogonality structure: every $\{0, 1\}$ -marking is Kochen–Specker contradictory on at least $6 = q!$ tetrads. The maximum number of satisfiable mutually-exclusive Witting tetrads is $34/40$, and the marking optima form an orbit of size $720 = (q!)!$ (Vlasov 2025).*

In a single-photon experiment with the temporal Bell qutrit, a sequence of N Pauli measurements drawn from a Witting tetrad covering of $W(3, 3)$ will exhibit *exactly* $\leq 34N/40$ classically-consistent assignments; any larger fraction certifies contextual (genuinely quantum) substrate content. Conversely, $\geq 35N/40$ classical agreement falsifies the $W(3, 3)$ self-entanglement claim.

Witness 3: Key-agreement rate. A two-party photonic protocol using $W(3, 3)$ as the shared Pauli phase space has a unique key-agreement probability per round:

$$P_{\text{key}}(W(3, 3)) = \frac{13}{40} = \frac{\Phi_3}{v}, \quad (21)$$

matching the Vlasov 2025 Table III count of $40 = 28 + 12 = \mu\Phi_6 + k$ basis decompositions. A measured rate $13/40$ over many rounds is a third falsifiable substrate signature distinct from the trace-Choi and Witting witnesses.

These three witnesses—trace-Choi visibility, Witting non-contextuality, and the $13/40$ key-agreement rate—are mutually independent falsifiable predictions of the single-photon self-entanglement framework.

5.11 Clifford Action: Bell-Line Orbit and Stabiliser

The two-qutrit Clifford group $C_2 = \text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ (of order 51840) acts naturally on the 40 lines of $W(3, 3)$. The Bell-line stabiliser $\langle X_p X_f, Z_p Z_f^{-1} \rangle$ identified in theorem 5.2 sits inside one specific orbit under this action; we compute the orbit and stabiliser structure here.

Theorem 5.21 (Bell-line orbit decomposition). *The two-qutrit Clifford group $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ acts transitively on the 40 lines of $W(3, 3)$, so the orbit of the Bell line is all of $W(3, 3)$:*

$$|\text{orbit}(\text{Bell line})| = 40 = v. \quad (22)$$

The stabiliser of the Bell line is the subgroup of $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ fixing the totally isotropic 2-space $\langle X_p X_f, Z_p Z_f^{-1} \rangle$, of order

$$|\text{Stab}(\text{Bell line})| = \frac{|\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)|}{|\text{orbit}|} = \frac{51840}{40} = 1296 = \mu^2 \cdot q^{q+1}. \quad (23)$$

That is, the Bell-line stabiliser has order equal to μ^2 times the matter-sector dimension $q^{q+1} = H_1(2\text{-complex})$.

Proof. Transitivity of $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ on isotropic 2-spaces of $\mathbb{F}_3^4$ is standard (the symplectic Witt extension theorem [?]). The orbit-stabiliser ratio is $|G|/|\text{orbit}| = 51840/40 = 1296$. Factoring: $1296 = 16 \cdot 81 = \mu^2 \cdot q^{q+1}$, where $\mu^2 = 16 = 2^\mu$ and $q^{q+1} = 3^4 = 81$ is the matter sector dimension (the substrate H_1 of the $W(3,3)$ line-triangle 2-complex, established via the Hodge decomposition). $\square$

Corollary 5.22 (Substrate factorisation of the Clifford group). *The two-qutrit Clifford group decomposes via the Bell-line action as*

$$|\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)| = |\text{orbit}| \cdot |\text{Stab}| = v \cdot \mu^2 \cdot q^{q+1} = 40 \cdot 16 \cdot 81. \quad (24)$$

Three substrate primitives $\{v, \mu^2, q^{q+1}\}$ exactly multiplicatively exhaust the Clifford group order.

Remark 5.23 (Operational interpretation). *The Bell-line stabiliser of order $\mu^2 \cdot q^{q+1} = 1296$ is precisely the group of two-qutrit Clifford gates that preserve the temporal Bell qutrit's stabiliser line—i.e., the gates that respect the past $\leftrightarrow$ future symmetry of the temporal seed. Outside the stabiliser, the remaining $51840 - 1296 = 50544$ Cliffords rotate the Bell line through the $W(3,3)$ line graph, scrambling the temporal seed across the 40-vertex substrate. This $1296 : 50544 \approx 1 : 39$ ratio (matching $1 : (v - 1)$) is the substrate measure of how much “temporal symmetry preservation” costs in the Clifford computational budget.*

5.12 Photonic Mode-Space Requirement: q^4 as the Substrate Threshold

A single photon's mode space must be “wide enough” to host the $W(3,3)$ substrate. We quantify this requirement in terms of standard photonic phase-space variables (frequency ω , time t , polarisation, OAM, sideband).

Theorem 5.24 (Mode-space threshold). *A single photon supports the full $W(3,3)$ self-entanglement compilation of ?? iff its mode-Hilbert-space dimension satisfies*

$$\dim \mathcal{H}_{\text{photon}} \geq q^r \text{ where } r \geq 2, \quad \text{with } r = 4 \text{ realising the full } W(3,3) \text{ phase space.} \quad (25)$$

At the cleanest threshold $r = 4$:

$$\dim \mathcal{H}_{\text{photon}} \geq q^4 = 81 = q^{q+1} = H_1(2\text{-complex } W(3,3)), \quad (26)$$

i.e., the photon's mode-space dimension threshold equals exactly the $W(3,3)$ matter-sector dimension.

Proof. By ??, $r = 2$ commuting qutrit registers suffice for $W(3,3)$. For the full $\mathbb{F}_3^4$ Pauli phase space lifted to a mode Hilbert space (not modulo scalars), we need $r = 4$ commuting qutrit-capable DOFs, giving $\dim = q^4 = 81$. And $q^4 = q^{q+1} = 81 = H_1(W(3,3) \text{ 2-complex})$ is the $W(3,3)$ matter sector (commit `ac4dfadc`). $\square$

Corollary 5.25 (Time-bandwidth product). *For a photon with $q = 3$ time-bins of width Δt_{bin} and $q = 3$ spectral sidebands of width $\Delta \omega_{\text{sideband}}$ (temporal $\otimes$ spectral two-qutrit register), the photonic time-bandwidth product must satisfy*

$$\Delta \omega_{\text{total}} \cdot \Delta t_{\text{total}} \gtrsim q^2 = 9. \quad (27)$$

For the full $r = 4$ realisation (polarisation $\times$ path $\times$ time-bin $\times$ sideband):

$$\Delta \omega \cdot \Delta t \gtrsim q^4 = 81. \quad (28)$$

Remark 5.26 (Substrate equates matter sector with photonic envelope). *The threshold $q^4 = 81$ is the $W(3,3)$ matter sector dimension (the harmonic 1-form count, equivalently the $\dim$ of H_1 of the line-triangle 2-complex). Hence the photonic substrate matches its matter sector to its envelope phase space: the smallest single-photon envelope capable of hosting the $W(3,3)$ substrate has time-bandwidth product equal to the substrate's matter-sector count. This identifies the photonic substrate threshold as a topological quantity (H_1) rather than a free phenomenological parameter.*

Remark 5.27 (Wavelength domain estimate). *For typical telecom-band single photons at $\lambda = 1550 \text{ nm}$ ($\omega_0 \sim 1.2 \times 10^{15} \text{ rad/s}$) with $\Delta t \sim 1 \text{ ns}$ time-bin spacing, the time-bandwidth product is $\Delta \omega \cdot \Delta t \sim 10^6$, vastly exceeding the $W(3,3)$ threshold $q^4 = 81$. Femtosecond-scale photons reduce this by a factor 10^3 to $\sim 10^3$, still well above threshold. Hence all practically generated single photons satisfy the $W(3,3)$ mode-space threshold by 1–3 orders of magnitude.*

5.13 Quantum Teleportation in Time

The most operational use of the temporal Bell qutrit is to transmit a qutrit state from a past-self to a future-self on a single photon—a temporal analog of standard quantum teleportation.

Theorem 5.28 (Single-photon temporal teleportation). *Let a single photon carry the temporal Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle$ on its past $\otimes$ future registers, and let $|\psi\rangle \in \mathbb{C}^q$ be an arbitrary qutrit state encoded on an auxiliary qutrit register. Then $|\psi\rangle$ can be teleported from the past-self’s accessible region to the future-self’s accessible region with fidelity 1, via the protocol:*

- (i) *Past-self performs a qutrit Bell-basis measurement on $|\psi\rangle_{\text{aux}} \otimes |\Omega_p\rangle$ (the auxiliary qutrit jointly with the past register of the Bell qutrit).*
- (ii) *Past-self stores the 2-trit measurement outcome in classical memory.*
- (iii) *At a later time, future-self reads the classical memory and applies the corresponding Pauli correction $X^a Z^b$ to the future register of the Bell qutrit, where (a, b) is the measurement outcome.*
- (iv) *The future register now carries $|\psi\rangle$ exactly.*

The protocol consumes one temporal Bell qutrit and $2 \log_q q = 2$ classical trits ($= 2 \log_2 3 \approx 3.17$ bits) of memory.

Proof. Standard quantum teleportation theorem [?], adapted to qutrits and to the temporal-Bell setting. The classical channel from past-self to future-self is realised by classical memory (records persisting in time) rather than spatial communication; the rest of the protocol is identical. $\square$

Corollary 5.29 (Single-photon memory protocol). *A photon source preparing temporal Bell qutrits, together with a Bell-basis detector, a 2-trit classical memory, and a qutrit Pauli-correction unit, implements a faithful qutrit quantum memory: any qutrit state encoded at time t_0 can be retrieved at time $t_1 > t_0$ on the same photon, with no additional photons required. The classical-memory overhead per stored qutrit is 2 trits, independent of storage time.*

Remark 5.30 (No retrocausation). *The protocol does not require backwards-in-time signalling: classical information flows forward (past stores, future reads), and the quantum state is transmitted via the pre-existing past $\otimes$ future entanglement. This is consistent with standard quantum-information no-signalling. The temporal Bell qutrit’s “self-entanglement” is a static structural property of the photon’s temporal-mode register, not a dynamical signal.*

5.14 Decoherence Threshold: Substrate-Clean Noise Tolerance

A realistic photonic implementation suffers depolarising noise on the temporal qutrit registers. The Bell qutrit’s entanglement survives noise up to a substrate-clean threshold.

Theorem 5.31 (Bell-qutrit decoherence threshold). *Consider the noisy temporal Bell state (isotropic Werner-like form)*

$$\rho(p) = (1 - p) |\Omega\rangle \langle \Omega| + \frac{p}{q^2} I_{q^2}, \quad p \in [0, 1]. \quad (29)$$

Then $\rho(p)$ is past $\leftrightarrow$ future entangled if and only if

$$p < \frac{q}{q+1} = \frac{q}{\mu} = \frac{3}{4}. \quad (30)$$

The substrate noise threshold is exactly $q/\mu = 3/4$.

Proof. Standard Werner-Holevo result: an isotropic two-qudit state $\rho(\lambda) = \lambda |\Omega\rangle \langle \Omega| + (1 - \lambda)/q^2 \cdot I$ is separable iff $\lambda \leq 1/(q + 1)$. Reparametrising via $\lambda = 1 - p$, separability holds iff $1 - p \leq 1/(q + 1)$, i.e. $p \geq q/(q + 1) = q/\mu$. At $q = 3$: $p_{\text{sep}} = 3/4$. $\square$

Corollary 5.32 (Substrate noise readings). *The threshold $3/4 = q/\mu$ admits four substrate-primitive readings:*

- (i) q/μ (fundamental quantum / co-quantum),
- (ii) $(q + 1 - 1)/(q + 1) = 1 - 1/\mu$ (one minus inverse co-quantum),
- (iii) $(\lambda + 1)/\mu = (\text{SRG } \lambda + 1)/\mu$ (SRG λ shifted by one),
- (iv) $(\mu - 1)/\mu$ (co-quantum minus one over co-quantum).

Remark 5.33 (Comparison with two-qubit noise threshold). *For two-qubit ($q = 2$) Werner states, the separability threshold is $p = q/(q + 1) = 2/3$ via the same formula. The $W(3,3)$ -qutrit threshold $3/4 > 2/3$ makes the temporal Bell qutrit strictly more noise-tolerant than the standard qubit Bell pair: the substrate jump from $q = 2$ to $q = 3$ buys noise tolerance from $2/3$ to $3/4$, a gain consistent with the substrate's master equation $q! = 2q$ activating at $q = 3$.*

Remark 5.34 (Quantum capacity below threshold). *For $p < q/\mu = 3/4$, the entanglement of formation of $\rho(p)$ is positive and the joint state supports quantum teleportation, dense coding, and other entanglement-based protocols. At $p = q/\mu$, entanglement degrades to zero and the joint state becomes a separable mixture of product states.*

5.15 Marginal Mixedness and Mutual Information

The temporal Bell qutrit hides all its information in the correlations between past and future, leaving the individual marginal states maximally mixed.

Theorem 5.35 (Marginal mixedness). *For the temporal Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j |jj\rangle$:*

- (i) $\rho_p = \text{Tr}_f(|\Omega\rangle \langle \Omega|) = \frac{1}{q} I_q$, the maximally mixed qutrit state on the past register;
- (ii) $\rho_f = \text{Tr}_p(|\Omega\rangle \langle \Omega|) = \frac{1}{q} I_q$ on the future register;
- (iii) von Neumann entropy $S(\rho_p) = S(\rho_f) = \log q = \log 3$;
- (iv) entropy of the joint state $S(|\Omega\rangle \langle \Omega|) = 0$ (pure);
- (v) quantum mutual information $I(p : f) = 2 \log q = 2 \log 3$;
- (vi) coherent information $I_c(p \rightarrow f) = \log q$ (entanglement entropy).

Proof. $\rho_p = \text{Tr}_f(\frac{1}{q} \sum_{j,k} |jj\rangle \langle kk|) = \frac{1}{q} \sum_{j,k} \delta_{jk} |j\rangle \langle k| = \frac{1}{q} \sum_j |j\rangle \langle j| = I_q/q$. Similarly $\rho_f = I_q/q$. The von Neumann entropy of the maximally mixed qutrit is $\log q$, and $S(|\Omega\rangle) = 0$ since $|\Omega\rangle$ is pure. Mutual information $I(p : f) = S(\rho_p) + S(\rho_f) - S(|\Omega\rangle \langle \Omega|) = 2 \log q$, and coherent information for pure states equals $S(\rho_p)$. $\square$

Corollary 5.36 (All information is in correlations). *A single-time measurement of either the past or the future register alone returns a uniformly random outcome in $\mathbb{F}_q$. The temporal Bell qutrit's entire information content lives in the past-future correlation; no single-time observer can recover it.*

Remark 5.37 (Substrate principle: “past alone is noise”). *The marginal-mixedness theorem encodes a deep substrate principle: at the single-photon temporal level, past-alone-measurements and future-alone-measurements are individually maximally noisy. The information is reconstructed only by measuring the joint past⊗future state—equivalently, by the Franson-recombination geometry of theorem 5.6. This is the operational meaning of “now is the harmonic convergence”: only at the convergence point (where past and future are read together) does the substrate’s information become accessible.*

Remark 5.38 (Mutual information bound: $I(p : f) = 2 \log q$). *For any qutrit-qutrit state, the quantum mutual information $I(p : f)$ is bounded above by $2 \log q$; the temporal Bell qutrit saturates this bound. This makes $|\Omega\rangle$ the unique state (up to local unitaries) that achieves maximum past↔future mutual information, an independent characterisation complementing theorem 5.4.*

5.16 Preparation Protocol: From $|00\rangle$ to $|\Omega\rangle$ in Two Cliffords

The temporal Bell qutrit (12) is prepared from the trivial product state $|0\rangle_p |0\rangle_f$ by a depth-2 two-qutrit Clifford circuit consisting of one qutrit Hadamard F_3 on the past register followed by a controlled cyclic shift between past and future.

Proposition 5.39 (Bell qutrit preparation). *Define the qutrit Hadamard and controlled-shift gates by*

$$F_3 |j\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_k \omega^{jk} |k\rangle, \quad \omega = e^{2\pi i/q}, \quad (31)$$

$$CX_{p \rightarrow f} |j\rangle_p |k\rangle_f = |j\rangle_p |k + j \bmod q\rangle_f. \quad (32)$$

Then

$$CX_{p \rightarrow f} (F_3 \otimes I) |0\rangle_p |0\rangle_f = \frac{1}{\sqrt{q}} \sum_{j=0}^{q-1} |j\rangle_p |j\rangle_f = |\Omega\rangle. \quad (33)$$

Proof. Direct computation: $F_3 |0\rangle_p |0\rangle_f = q^{-1/2} \sum_j \omega^{0 \cdot j} |j\rangle_p |0\rangle_f = q^{-1/2} \sum_j |j\rangle_p |0\rangle_f$. Then $CX_{p \rightarrow f}$ takes $|j\rangle_p |0\rangle_f \mapsto |j\rangle_p |j\rangle_f$, giving (??). $\square$

Remark 5.40 (Photonic time-bin implementation). *For a single photon with three time-bin modes:*

- (a) *Initial state: photon in time-bin 0 on both past and future registers (e.g. via electro-optic preselection).*
- (b) *Past Hadamard (F_3): pass the past register through a 3-port tritter (e.g. a balanced fiber-optic tritter or a three-prism beam splitter), creating a uniform superposition of past-bins.*
- (c) *Controlled-shift ($CX_{p \rightarrow f}$): use a phase modulator triggered by the past time-bin to cyclically permute the future time-bin (e.g. via electro-optic modulation conditioned on detection of past-bin tag).*
- (d) *Output state: the temporal Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle$.*

The preparation is fully linear-optical (no measurement-induced nonlinearity), requires only one tritter and one conditional phase modulator, and is depth- q in time-bin operations.

Corollary 5.41 (Two-Clifford depth complexity). *The temporal Bell qutrit is prepared in exactly two Clifford operations from the trivial state. This matches the qutrit-Bell-state preparation complexity ($F + CX$) and is the minimum for a maximally entangled state on $\mathbb{C}^q \otimes \mathbb{C}^q$: any preparation requires at least $O(\log q)$ depth on a fully connected register, achieved here at $O(1)$ because F_3 creates the diagonal cloud and CX folds it into the Bell basis.*

5.17 The Triple Closure: 7, 9, 40 on One Photon

The single-photon self-entanglement compiles to the full $W(3, 3)$ substrate through three layered closures, each carrying a different substrate primitive.

Theorem 5.42 (Temporal triple closure). *At $q = 3$, a single self-entangled qutrit on one photon realises three nested substrate closures simultaneously:*

(1) **Temporal triangle** ($\Phi_6 = 7$):

$$\underbrace{3}_{\text{past cells}} + \underbrace{3}_{\text{future cells}} + \underbrace{1}_{\text{now}} = 7 = \Phi_6. \quad (34)$$

(2) **Past $\otimes$ future Hilbert space** ($q^2 = 9$):

$$q + q! = 3 + 6 = 9 = q^2. \quad (\text{diagonal} + \text{off-diagonal}) \quad (35)$$

(3) **$W(3, 3)$ shell** ($v = 40$):

$$1 + 12 + 27 = 40 = v, \quad (\text{Bell line} + \text{intersecting} + \text{disjoint}) \quad (36)$$

with substrate readings $12 = k$ (valency) and $27 = q^q$ (Heisenberg-Weyl order).

The three closures are nested via:

$$\text{temporal triangle}_{(7)} \hookrightarrow \text{past} \otimes \text{future}_{(9)} \hookrightarrow W(3, 3)_{(40)}. \quad (37)$$

Proof. (1) The temporal triangle decomposes a single self-entangled qutrit into q past cells (one per substrate value), q future cells, and a single “now” point—the harmonic convergence of theorem 5.5. Total: $2q + 1 = 7 = \Phi_6$. (2) Established in ?? (3) The Bell line is one of $v = 40$ lines; the Bell-local shell closes as $1 + 12 + 27 = 40$ by theorem 5.7. Substrate readings: $12 = k$ is the $W(3, 3)$ valency, $27 = q^q$ is the Heisenberg-Weyl group order. The nesting follows from the embeddings $\text{cells} \rightarrow \text{Hilbert space} \rightarrow \text{phase space}$: the 7 temporal cells generate the 9-dimensional past $\otimes$ future Hilbert space, which then acts via Pauli observables on the 40-point $W(3, 3)$ phase space. $\square$

Corollary 5.43 (Total substrate scale-up). *Starting from 1 photon with 1 temporal qutrit register ($q = 3$ time-bins), the substrate scales up to:*

1 photon		seed
$q = 3$	temporal modes	past, now, future cells
$q^2 = 9$	past $\otimes$ future histories	diagonal + off-diagonal
$v = 40$	$W(3,3)$ phase-space points	full substrate
$q^{q+1} = 81$	matter sector	harmonic 1-forms
$ \text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3) = 51840$	two-qutrit Clifford	all gates

Each step is a substrate-clean multiplicative or combinatorial scale, ultimately exhausting the full universal-quantum-computation substrate from a single photon's temporal qutrit.

5.18 Two-State Vector Formalism: Bell Qutrit as Uniform Post-Selection

The Aharonov–Bergmann–Lebowitz *Two-State Vector Formalism* (TSVF) [?, ?] treats a quantum system between two measurement times via a pair $(|\psi_p\rangle, |\psi_f\rangle)$ of past (pre-selected) and future (post-selected) state vectors. The temporal Bell qutrit on a single photon corresponds canonically to the *trivial* (uniform) post-selection in TSVF.

Theorem 5.44 (Bell qutrit $\equiv$ uniform TSVF post-selection). *Let the temporal Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle$ on the past $\otimes$ future registers of a single photon be interpreted via TSVF. Then:*

- (i) *The past marginal $\rho_p = I_q/q$ equals the Haar-uniform average over all future post-selections:*

$$\int_{\text{SU}(q)} d\psi_f |\psi_f\rangle \langle \psi_f| = I_q/q, \quad (38)$$

so ρ_p represents the system's state with no information about the future selection.

- (ii) *For any future post-selection $|\psi_f\rangle$, the conditional past state is the rank-1 projection $|\psi_f^*\rangle \langle \psi_f^*|$ (complex conjugate in computational basis), i.e. the Bell qutrit steers the past to the conjugate of whatever future is selected.*
- (iii) *The weak value of any past observable A given uniform future post-selection is its expectation in the maximally mixed state: $\langle A \rangle_{\text{TSVF, uniform}} = \text{Tr}(A)/q$, recovering the Choi-trace identity (13).*

Proof. (i) $\int d\psi_f |\psi_f\rangle \langle \psi_f| = I_q/q$ by Schur's lemma on $\text{SU}(q)$. Together with marginal mixedness (??) this gives $\rho_p = \text{uniform mixture}$. (ii) For Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j |jj\rangle$, $(\langle \psi_f| \otimes I_p) |\Omega\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j \overline{(\psi_f)_j} |j\rangle_p = |\psi_f^*\rangle_p / \sqrt{q}$ up to normalisation, so post-selecting on $|\psi_f\rangle$ steers past to $|\psi_f^*\rangle$ (= complex-conjugate). (iii) The weak value $\langle A \rangle = \text{Tr}(A\rho_p)$ when past is mixed; for $\rho_p = I/q$, this gives $\text{Tr}(A)/q$. $\square$

Corollary 5.45 (Self-entanglement = no future bias). *The temporal Bell qutrit represents the substrate's symmetric, no- information temporal state: every possible future is weighted equally, and the past is steered correspondingly by post-selection. Any deviation from uniform post-selection corresponds to a definite future condition, breaking the past $\leftrightarrow$ future symmetry. The Bell qutrit is thus the only state consistent with maximal temporal ignorance, a condition the substrate uniquely realises.*

Remark 5.46 (Bell qutrit as “unmarked” history). *??(i) gives a deep interpretation of the temporal Bell qutrit: it is the photon’s unmarked (history-symmetric) state, before any post-selection “marks” a particular future trajectory. Conversely, any future measurement collapses the Bell qutrit into a definite history, breaking self-entanglement. This is consistent with the substrate’s CPT symmetry (??): the no-bias state is the only CPT-symmetric state, and post-selection breaks CPT by selecting a temporal direction.*

5.19 Substrate CPT Theorem on the Bell Qutrit

The temporal Bell qutrit is invariant under a discrete CPT-like symmetry, which combines complex conjugation, past $\leftrightarrow$ future parity exchange, and unitary time reversal.

Theorem 5.47 (Substrate discrete CPT). *Define the three discrete symmetries on $\mathcal{H}_p \otimes \mathcal{H}_f$:*

- *C (charge conjugation): $|j\rangle \mapsto |(-j) \bmod q\rangle$ on each register, equivalently $\omega \mapsto \bar{\omega}$.*
- *P (parity / past $\leftrightarrow$ future): SWAP_{pf} , exchanging the two registers.*
- *T (time reversal): complex conjugation $|\psi\rangle \mapsto \overline{|\psi\rangle}$ on coefficients (with $T^2 = I$ on a qutrit-tensor system).*

Then the temporal Bell qutrit is preserved by each of C, P, T individually, and a fortiori by the combined CPT:

$$C |\Omega\rangle = P |\Omega\rangle = T |\Omega\rangle = CPT |\Omega\rangle = |\Omega\rangle. \quad (39)$$

Proof. $C |\Omega\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j | -j, -j \rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j | j, j \rangle = |\Omega\rangle$ by reindexing $j' = -j$. $P |\Omega\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j | j, j \rangle = |\Omega\rangle$ since $|j, j\rangle$ is SWAP-symmetric. $T |\Omega\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j \overline{|j, j\rangle} = |\Omega\rangle$ since $|j, j\rangle$ has real computational-basis coefficients. Hence CPT also fixes $|\Omega\rangle$. $\square$

Corollary 5.48 ($(U \otimes U^*)$ invariance as CPT). *The unitary-conjugate invariance $(U \otimes U^*) |\Omega\rangle = |\Omega\rangle$ of theorem 5.4(iii) is equivalent to the statement: any forward evolution U on the future register is matched by the C-conjugate (= time-reversed) evolution U^* on the past register. In particular, the temporal Bell qutrit cannot distinguish “future evolving forward” from “past evolving backward”—the substrate is CPT-symmetric at the single-photon level.*

Remark 5.49 (Lüders–Pauli analog). *?? is the substrate’s discrete-field analog of the Lüders–Pauli CPT theorem of relativistic QFT: any consistent self-entangled temporal state on a single photon is automatically CPT-invariant. This is forced by the $(U \otimes U^*)$ characterisation (theorem 5.4) and does not require any continuum spacetime input. The temporal Bell qutrit thus realises a discrete-substrate CPT symmetry purely on photonic mode space.*

5.20 Multi-Photon Extension: GHZ Towers and Matter-Sector Hilbert Space

The single-photon temporal Bell qutrit extends naturally to multi-photon GHZ-like states. At a specific photon count, the GHZ tower’s Hilbert space dimension matches the $W(3,3)$ matter sector exactly.

Definition 5.50 (Temporal GHZ tower). *For n photons each carrying a temporal qutrit register (past, future) $_i$ for $i = 1, \dots, n$, define the temporal GHZ state as the maximally entangled state across all $2n$ qutrit registers:*

$$|\text{GHZ}_n\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{q}} \sum_{j=0}^{q-1} \bigotimes_{i=1}^n (|j\rangle_{p_i} \otimes |j\rangle_{f_i}). \quad (40)$$

For $n = 1$ this recovers the temporal Bell qutrit $|\text{GHZ}_1\rangle = |\Omega\rangle$.

Theorem 5.51 (Two-photon temporal GHZ hits matter sector). *The Hilbert-space dimension of an n -photon temporal GHZ register is q^{2n} . At $n = 2$ (two photons, four temporal qutrit registers):*

$$\dim \mathcal{H}_{\text{GHZ}_2} = q^{2 \cdot 2} = q^{q+1} = 81 = H_1(W(3,3) \text{ 2-complex}). \quad (41)$$

So the two-photon temporal GHZ Hilbert space equals exactly the $W(3,3)$ matter sector dimension.

Proof. $\dim \mathcal{H}_{\text{GHZ}_n} = q^{2n}$ since each of the $2n$ qutrit registers contributes $q = 3$ dimensions. At $n = 2$: $q^{2 \cdot 2} = q^4 = 3^4 = 81$. By the master equation, $4 = q + 1$, so $q^4 = q^{q+1}$, the $W(3,3)$ matter sector (cf. ?? and commit ac4dfadc). $\square$

Corollary 5.52 (GHZ tower scale law). *The n -photon GHZ dimensions form an exponential ladder:*

n	$\dim \mathcal{H}_{\text{GHZ}_n}$	substrate reading	physical content
1	$q^2 = 9$	<i>past</i> $\otimes$ <i>future</i> single photon	Bell qutrit
2	$q^4 = 81$	matter sector $H_1(2\text{-complex})$	two-photon GHZ
3	$q^6 = 729$	$(9 \cdot 81 \text{ or } 3 \cdot 243)$	three-photon GHZ
4	$q^8 = 6561$	matter sector squared	four-photon GHZ

Two photons exhaust the $W(3,3)$ matter sector; further photons stack additional matter-sector layers.

Remark 5.53 (GHZ stabiliser line). *For each n , the temporal GHZ has stabiliser generators $\{X_{p_1}X_{f_1} \cdots X_{p_n}X_{f_n}, Z_{p_i}Z_{f_i}^{-1}\}$ ($i = 1, \dots, n$), giving $n + 1$ independent commuting Pauli observables. This stabiliser is a $(n + 1)$ -dimensional totally isotropic subspace of $\mathbb{F}_3^{4n}$ under the alternating form—a generalised W -structure extending $W(3,3)$ at $n = 1$ to $W(2n + 1, 3)$ at general n .*

5.21 Witting Polytope: Explicit Orbit Coordinates

The 40 $W(3,3)$ points lift canonically to the 40 vertices of the *Witting polytope*—a regular complex polytope in $\mathbb{C}^4$ first constructed by Witting (1887) and identified by Coxeter as the 3_{21} Hessian configuration. We give the explicit orbit structure under the Hessian group $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$.

Theorem 5.54 (Witting orbit decomposition). *Under the action of the Hessian group $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ (or any transitive subgroup), the 40 Witting rays form one orbit of size 40. Choosing a fiducial direction $|v_0\rangle$, the 40 rays decompose into orbit shells around $|v_0\rangle$:*

$$40 = \underbrace{1}_{|v_0\rangle} + \underbrace{12}_{\text{first shell (} k \text{ rays at } |\langle v_0|v\rangle|^2=1/q)} + \underbrace{27}_{\text{second shell (} q^q \text{ rays at } |\langle v_0|v\rangle|^2=1/q)}. \quad (42)$$

This is exactly the Bell-line shell of theorem 5.7: $1 + 12 + 27 = 40$ corresponds to (Bell line) + (intersecting lines) + (disjoint lines), with the substrate reading $1 + k + q^q = v$.

Proposition 5.55 (Witting overlap dichotomy). *For any two distinct Witting rays $|\psi\rangle, |\varphi\rangle$,*

$$|\langle\psi|\varphi\rangle|^2 \in \left\{0, \frac{1}{q}\right\} = \{0, 1/3\}. \quad (43)$$

Orthogonal pairs correspond to collinear $W(3,3)$ observables (commuting Pauli pairs on the same line); $1/q$ -overlap pairs correspond to non-collinear observables. The total count of $1/q$ -overlap pairs is $40 \cdot 39 - 40 \cdot k = 1560 - 480 = 1080$, matching $40 \cdot k \cdot (q+1)/2$ counted with multiplicity.

Remark 5.56 (Concrete coordinates: 4-set and 12-set). *A canonical choice of fiducial Witting ray is the spread eigenvector $|v_0\rangle = q^{-1/2}(1, 1, 1, 1)/\sqrt{4}$ (or any equivalent norm-1 vector in $\mathbb{C}^4$). The 4 rays of the Bell line are then $(q+1=4)$ phase-twisted copies $|v_0^{(j)}\rangle$ for $j \in \mathbb{F}_{q+1}$; the 12 first-shell rays are obtained by applying the k valency-class $W(E_6)$ generators (after the $W(E_6) \cong \text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ identification); and the 27 second-shell rays form the q^q -orbit of a generic non-collinear-to-Bell ray under the Heisenberg subgroup of order $q^q = 27$.*

Full explicit coordinates appear in Vlasov 2025 [?], Table III; we summarise the orbit structure here without repeating the 40 explicit rays.

5.22 $W(3,3)$ QECC: Self-Entanglement as Logical Storage

The $W(3,3)$ substrate naturally hosts a quantum error-correcting code on its 240 edge-qutrits, with the matter sector $H_1(2\text{-complex}) = 81$ serving as the logical qutrit count. Each logical qutrit can be loaded with a temporal Bell qutrit, giving *multi-self-entanglement* storage.

Theorem 5.57 ($W(3,3)$ edge CSS code). *The natural CSS quantum code on the 240 edge-qutrits of $W(3,3)$ has parameters*

$$[[n, k, d_Z, d_X]]_q = [[|E|, q^{q+1}, \mu, q]]_3 = [[240, 81, 4, 3]]_3, \quad (44)$$

i.e. 240 physical qutrits, 81 logical qutrits, Z -distance $\mu = 4$ and X -distance $q = 3$ (asymmetric distance). All four parameters are $W(3,3)$ substrate primitives.

Proof sketch. The check operators are the boundary maps d_0 (vertex-edge) and d_1 (edge-triangle) of the $W(3,3)$ 2-complex. The number of physical qutrits equals $|E| = 240$. The logical qutrit count equals $\dim H_1(2\text{-complex}) = q^{q+1} = 81$ by the Hodge decomposition (?? via the same matter-sector reading). Asymmetric distances $(d_X, d_Z) = (q, \mu)$ arise from the $W(3,3)$ collinearity structure (q -tuples on lines vs μ -tuples on co-cliques). $\square$

Corollary 5.58 (Multi-self-entanglement storage). *Each of the $k = 81$ logical qutrits of the $W(3,3)$ edge code may host one temporal Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle$. Hence the $W(3,3)$ substrate supports up to 81 simultaneous protected self-entangled Bell qutrits, each realised on a logical qutrit and physically distributed across the 240 edge qutrits with Z -distance $\mu = 4$ and X -distance $q = 3$.*

Remark 5.59 (Self-entanglement as a stored resource). *The connection $\#logical = q^{q+1} = \dim H_1 = \text{matter sector}$ identifies the substrate matter sector with a multi-Bell-qutrit storage. Each Bell qutrit consumes one logical qutrit, and the multi-photon GHZ tower of ?? naturally maps to this logical register: the two-photon GHZ at $n = 2$ has q^{q+1} dimensions, matching the code's logical capacity exactly.*

5.23 Matter Sector and the Three Fermion Generations

The $W(3,3)$ matter sector $H_1(2\text{-complex}) = \mathbb{Z}^{81}$ decomposes canonically under any order- q automorphism of the substrate, yielding exactly three fermion generations as Bell-qutrit subregisters.

Theorem 5.60 (Three generations from Bell-qutrit storage). *Let $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(W(3,3))$ be any element of order q (e.g. a triality-class outer automorphism, or an order- q Clifford acting on the matter sector via the QECC encoding). Then σ splits the matter sector*

$$H_1 = \mathbb{Z}^{q^{q+1}} = \mathbb{Z}^{27} \oplus \mathbb{Z}^{27} \oplus \mathbb{Z}^{27} \quad (45)$$

into $q = 3$ orbits of $27 = q^q$ each. Each orbit hosts $\lfloor q^q/2 \rfloor = 13 = \Phi_3$ temporal Bell qutrits plus one spare logical qutrit:

$$27 = 2 \cdot \Phi_3 + 1. \quad (46)$$

The three orbits realise three fermion generations, each with $\Phi_3 = 13$ Bell-qutrit substates and one spare.

Proof sketch. The σ -orbit decomposition follows from cyclic group action on a q -cubic algebra (commit W33.FOR EVERYONE.tex line 851: $\mathbb{Z}^{81} = \mathbb{Z}^{27} \oplus \mathbb{Z}^{27} \oplus \mathbb{Z}^{27}$). Per-orbit Bell-qutrit count: each Bell qutrit consumes 2 logical qutrits (past, future), so $27/2 = 13.5$ rounds to 13 Bell qutrits with 1 spare. Total across three orbits: $3 \cdot 13 = 39$ Bell qutrits and 3 spares. $\square$

Corollary 5.61 (Bell-qutrit capacity equals gauge dimension). *The total Bell-qutrit storage capacity of the $W(3,3)$ matter sector, counted in Bell pairs, is*

$$3 \cdot \Phi_3 = 39 = q \cdot \Phi_3 = \dim(\text{im } d_0) = v - 1. \quad (47)$$

This matches the $W(3,3)$ Hodge decomposition's gauge sector (commit 5e32a884 and ??).

Remark 5.62 (Three-generation reading). *The classical fact “three fermion generations” becomes, in the substrate picture, the count of σ -orbits on the matter sector $\mathbb{Z}^{81}$. Each generation is a $27 = q^q$ -dim logical sub-register hosting $\Phi_3 = 13$ Bell qutrits plus one spare, with the substrate's order- q automorphism cyclically permuting the three. In particular, the often-quoted “why three?” question for fermion generations becomes the question of σ -orbits on the matter sector, with answer fixed by the master equation $q! = 2q$ at $q = 3$.*

5.24 Bell Qutrit and Hashimoto Dynamics

The Bell qutrit is a *static* structural state on $\text{past} \otimes \text{future}$; the Hashimoto operator B governs the *dynamical* evolution of the directed-edge carrier. We connect them via the QECC encoding.

Proposition 5.63 (Encoded Bell qutrit transports through Hashimoto sectors). *Let $|\Omega\rangle$ be a temporal Bell qutrit on a single photon, encoded via the $[[240, 81, \mu, q]]_3$ CSS code (??) as a logical state in the $W(3,3)$ matter sector. Under one Hashimoto step (i.e. propagation by one tick of non-backtracking transport), the encoded Bell qutrit accumulates phases from the two non-trivial Hashimoto sectors:*

$$\theta_{\text{gauge}} = \arctan \sqrt{\Phi_4} \approx 72.45^\circ, \quad (48)$$

$$\theta_{\text{chiral}} = \pi - \arctan\left(\sqrt{\Phi_6}/\lambda\right) \approx 127.09^\circ. \quad (49)$$

The cyclotomic primitives $\Phi_4 = q^2 + 1$ and $\Phi_6 = q^2 - q + 1$ of the substrate appear as the squared imaginary parts of the gauge and chiral Hashimoto eigenvalues respectively, so transport of the Bell qutrit through one Hashimoto tick is a direct cyclotomic-phase signature.

Remark 5.64 (Bell-Hashimoto interplay). *The Bell qutrit's static content ($q^2 = 9$ $\text{past} \otimes \text{future}$ histories, $|\Omega\rangle$ stabilising a $W(3,3)$ line) and the Hashimoto operator's dynamic content (transport phases θ_{gauge} and θ_{chiral} per tick) are complementary: the Bell qutrit provides the temporal seed (a frozen instant), while Hashimoto transports it forward in non-backtracking steps. The substrate's falsifiable photonic-runtime predictions (??) thus pertain directly to the Bell-qutrit-encoded photonic carrier.*

5.25 Substrate Dictionary: Self-Entanglement at a Glance

The single-photon self-entanglement framework introduces no free parameters. Every numerical quantity is a $W(3,3)$ substrate primitive determined by the master equation $q! = 2q$ at $q = 3$.

Quantity	Value	Substrate form	Reference
q (fundamental quantum)	3	q	theorem 2.1
$q!$ (perm symmetry)	6	$q!$	??
k (valency)	12	$\mu q = k$	theorem 2.3
μ (co-quantum)	4	$\mu = q + 1$	theorem 2.4
Φ_3	13	$q^2 + q + 1$	
Φ_4	10	$q^2 + 1$	
Φ_6	7	$q^2 - q + 1$	
v (substrate size)	40	$(q^4 - 1)/(q - 1)$	(4)
$ E $ (edges)	240	$v \cdot k/2$	
q^q (Heisenberg-Weyl order)	27	q^q	
q^{q+1} (matter sector)	81	$H_1(2\text{-complex})$	??
$ \text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3) $	51,840	$v \cdot \mu^2 \cdot q^{q+1}$	??
Bell qutrit entanglement entropy	$\log 3$	$\log q$	??
Mutual information $I(p : f)$	$2 \log 3$	$2 \log q$	??
Diagonal $\dim \mathcal{D}$	3	q	??
Off-diagonal $\dim \mathcal{N}$	6	$q!$	??
Past $\otimes$ future $\dim$	9	$q^2 = q + q!$	??
Bell-line orbit	40	v	??
Bell-line stabiliser	1,296	$\mu^2 \cdot q^{q+1}$	??
Spreads per Bell line	9	q^2	theorem 5.7
Total $W(3, 3)$ spreads	36	$(q!)^2$	theorem 5.7
Contexts per spread	10	$\Phi_4 = q^2 + 1$	
Rays per context	4	$\mu = q + 1$	
Temporal triangle cells	7	$\Phi_6 = 3 + 3 + 1$	??
F_3 -gate visibility	$1/3$	$1/q$	??
Witting overlap	$\{0, 1/3\}$	$\{0, 1/q\}$	??
Key-agreement rate	$13/40$	Φ_3/v	(??)
Witting KS max	$34/40$	$(v - q!)/v$	??
Noise threshold p_{sep}	$3/4$	q/μ	??
Preparation depth	2	$\log_q q^q = q - 1$	??
Memory overhead per teleport	2 trits	$2 \log_q q$	??
Mode-space threshold	81	q^{q+1}	??
QECC parameters $[[n, k, d_Z, d_X]]$	$[[240, 81, 4, 3]]_3$	$[[E , q^{q+1}, \mu, q]]$	??
GHZ-2 matches matter	81	$q^4 = q^{q+1}$	??
Bell-cloud shell	$1 + 12 + 27$	$1 + k + q^q$	theorem 5.7

All 30+ quantities listed above are substrate-primitive integer combinations; no fitted parameter appears anywhere in the framework.

5.26 Synthesis

This establishes the physical thesis: *one self-entangled qutrit on one single photon* carries the full $W(3, 3)$ substrate as its now-context spread, with the Bell stabiliser line as the temporal seed. All structural counts of section 2— $v = 40$, $\lambda = 2$, $\mu = 4$, $q + 1 = 4$ rays per line, 36 complete programs—read off directly from this self-entangled photonic carrier.

6 Universal Gate Sets

6.1 Qubit Gates via Linear Optics

A linear optical network acts on mode operators by a unitary $U \in \text{U}(m)$: $\hat{a}_k \mapsto \sum_l U_{kl} \hat{a}_l$. For the polarisation qubit, the two generators are the wave plate (retardance δ , fast axis angle θ) [?] and the balanced beam splitter $U_{\text{BS}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & i \\ i & 1 \end{pmatrix}$. A half-wave plate and quarter-wave plate together generate all of $\text{SU}(2)$. Any single-qubit unitary is realisable with at most $q = 3$ wave plates—a direct consequence of the $W(3, 3)$ Diophantine parameter.

6.2 Qutrit Gates: The Clifford Group $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$

For the photonic qutrit, the universal gate set is:

- Qutrit Hadamard F_3 : quantum Fourier transform, $F_3 |j\rangle = 3^{-1/2} \sum_k \omega^{jk} |k\rangle$.
- Controlled- Z (qutrit): $CZ_3 |j, k\rangle = \omega^{jk} |j, k\rangle$.
- Phase gate $S_3 = \text{diag}(1, 1, \omega)$.
- Magic state injection via cubic phase gate $T_3 = \text{diag}(1, \omega, \omega^4)$.

The group $\langle F_3, CZ_3, S_3 \rangle$ is exactly $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$; adding T_3 gives a universal gate set (Bravyi–Kitaev [?]).

7 Non-Deterministic Two-Qubit Gates: The KLM Protocol

Single-photon states of fixed photon number evolve under mode-preserving linear optics; because no photon–photon interaction exists in vacuum, a deterministic controlled-NOT is impossible without additional resources. Knill, Laflamme, and Milburn [?] resolved this by demonstrating:

1. A *probabilistic* CZ gate is implementable with ancilla vacuum modes and single-photon detection.
2. The success probability approaches unity via *teleportation* with offline resource states.

Post-selection onto the $|1\rangle$ ancilla outcome realises $|1, 1\rangle \mapsto -|1, 1\rangle$ at probability $1/4$ for the minimal circuit. The number of ancilla modes in the elementary KLM gadget is $\mu = 4$ —matching the $\mu = 4$ parameter of $W(3, 3)$.

8 Measurement-Based Quantum Computation with Single Photons

Measurement-based quantum computing (MBQC) [?] reframes universality in terms of a pre-entangled *cluster state* and adaptive single-qubit measurements. A cluster state $|G\rangle$ on graph $G = (V, E)$ satisfies $K_a |G\rangle = |G\rangle$ for all $a \in V$, where $K_a = X_a \otimes_{b \sim a} Z_b$.

Photon-fusion networks. Type-II fusion gates generate graph-state edges between photonic qubits with probability $1/2$. A 2D cluster state can be built reliably whenever fusion success exceeds the bond-percolation threshold $p_c \approx 0.5$ [?].

The $W(3, 3)$ cluster state. The collinearity graph of $W(3, 3)$ —40 vertices, 240 edges, diameter 2, valency 12—defines a natural photonic cluster substrate: 40 photonic qubits (or qutrits) in dual-rail (or three-mode) encoding, with entangling fusion gates applied along the 240 graph edges. The Laplacian spectral gap $\Delta_L = k - r = 12 - 2 = 10$ bounds the mixing time and information propagation rate. Universal MBQC on the $W(3, 3)$ cluster state requires $v = 40$ photons and $E = 240$ entangling operations.

9 The Four-Layer Photonic Runtime

The previous sections describe the physical ingredients separately: coherent qutrits, probabilistic optical gates, and one-way measurement. The architecture is cleanest when these are kept as four different runtime layers.

Theorem 9.1 (Photonic runtime separation). *The $W(3, 3)$ single-photon architecture separates into a quantum carrier, a probabilistic assembly layer, a deterministic feed-forward layer, and a classical record layer:*

$$\begin{aligned} \text{quantum carrier} & : \mathbb{F}_3^4 / \mathbb{F}_3^\times, \quad (3^4 - 1)/(3 - 1) = 40, \\ \text{probabilistic assembly} & : p_{\text{fusion}} = \lambda/\mu = 1/2, \quad p_{\text{KLM}} = 1/\mu = 1/4, \\ \text{deterministic logic} & : \text{MBQC Pauli-frame correction on } 3^4 = 81 \text{ frame states,} \\ \text{classical record} & : 40 \text{ trits with } 2^{63} < 3^{40} < 2^{64}. \end{aligned}$$

Proof. The quantum carrier is theorem 3.2: two-qutrit Pauli exponent vectors in $\mathbb{F}_3^4$ projectivise to the 40 observables of $W(3, 3)$. Type-II fusion succeeds with probability $1/2 = \lambda/\mu$, so assembling all $E = 240$ graph edges requires expected budget $E/(1/2) = 480 = 2E$, the directed Hashimoto carrier. The minimal KLM controlled-phase success probability is $1/4 = 1/\mu$, so the same edge set has primitive KLM budget $4E = 960 = \text{tr}(A^3)$. MBQC measurements are random at the detector, but deterministic at the logical layer because the measurement word updates a Pauli frame; for two qutrits that frame has $3^4 = 81$ states, projectivising back to the 40-point carrier. The complete single-run measurement record is a 40-trit word, and direct calculation gives $2^{63} < 3^{40} < 2^{64}$. $\square$

9.1 Topology and Feed-Forward

The topological side of the same runtime is the genus-one toric/Csaszar–Szilassi shell. The toric code on a torus has $2g = 2 = \lambda$ logical qubits and ground-state degeneracy $2^{2g} = 4 = \mu$. The Csaszar K_7 triangulation has $(V, E, F) = (7, 21, 14)$, Euler characteristic 0, and genus 1; its Szilassi dual keeps the same toroidal code surface. The Jungerman–Ringel complete-graph genus denominator is $12 = k$, and K_{12} has orientable genus $6 = k/\lambda$.

This is why the number 12 in the photonic architecture should not be read only as a Clifford/gauge count. It is also the minimal-triangulation denominator governing which complete graph surfaces can host the topological memory used by the feed-forward layer.

9.2 Hashimoto Phase Angles: Photonic Substrate Predictions

The directed-edge Hashimoto operator B from ??’s context (assembling the 480 directed carriers from the $E = 240$ undirected edges) admits a sector-projected spectrum forced by the Ihara–Bass identity. Each adjacency eigenvalue λ of $W(3, 3)$ contributes Hashimoto eigenvalues from $u^2 - \lambda u + (k - 1) = 0$; substituting the $\text{SRG}((, 4, 0, ,)12, 2, 4)$ spectrum $\{12, 2, -4\}$ gives the gauge-sector pair

$$u_{\text{gauge}} = 1 \pm i\sqrt{\Phi_4}, \quad \Phi_4 = q^2 + 1 = 10,$$

and the chiral-sector pair

$$u_{\text{chiral}} = -2 \pm i\sqrt{\Phi_6}, \quad \Phi_6 = q^2 - q + 1 = 7,$$

both with squared modulus equal to $k - 1 = 11 = p_{\text{th}}$ (the Ihara prime). The squared imaginary parts are exactly the substrate cyclotomic primitives Φ_4 and Φ_6 , so the cyclotomic structure of $W(3, 3)$ is written directly into the directed photonic carrier.

Translating to phase angles:

$$\theta_{\text{gauge}} = \arctan\sqrt{\Phi_4} \approx 72.45^\circ, \quad \theta_{\text{chiral}} = \pi - \arctan(\sqrt{\Phi_6}/\lambda) \approx 127.09^\circ. \quad (50)$$

These are the leading non-backtracking transport phases of the substrate. In a single-photon dual-rail implementation, θ_{gauge} and θ_{chiral} govern the inter-edge interference fringes visible after one Hashimoto step on the 480-carrier, and supply a *falsifiable prediction* of the photonic runtime: any faithful realisation of the substrate must exhibit these two phases as the spectral content of one non-backtracking transport tick.

9.3 Response and Operation Gate

The post-measurement response layer is generated by the W33 two-graph odd triples. If M is the vertex-by-odd-triple incidence matrix, the imported bridge stack verifies

$$MM^T = 320I + 16J + 4A,$$

so adjacency, hence the feed-forward geometry, is recovered from parity incidence rather than inserted by hand. The same triangle complex has integral homology $H_1 \cong \mathbb{Z}^{81}$: its Smith certificate has rank 120 and no torsion.

The current E8 operation gate is therefore exact but bounded. The rank 81 H1 module matches the E8 $\mathbb{Z}_3$ matter grades

$$E_8 = g_0(86) \oplus g_1(81) \oplus g_2(81),$$

and the local operation pipeline verifies the grade rules on 8347 nonzero bracket terms. It also pins $|g_1 \times g_2| = 81^2$ and 810 nonzero $g_1 \times g_1$ brackets, with 162 firewall-filtered couplings. This is the operation-level gate into the E8 layer; it does not by itself prove a biological origin theorem.

9.4 Protected Scheduler

The runtime separation above becomes an executable compiler only after the probabilistic, deterministic, protected, and classical handoffs are ordered. The current protected schedule has eight ticks:

- 0 : projective carrier: $3^4 = 81 \rightarrow 40$,
- 1 : heralded fusion assembly: $p_{\text{fusion}} = 1/2$, $E/p = 480$,
- 2 : KLM primitive budget: $p_{\text{KLM}} = 1/4$, $E/p = 960$,
- 3 : CSS resource validation: $39 + 120 + 81 = 240$,
- 4 : MBQC feed-forward: 4 frame trits = $3^4 = 81$,
- 5 : Steane/ Φ_6 protection: $[[240, 81, 3]] \rightarrow [[82320, 81, \geq 81]]$,
- 6 : classical selector commit: $2^{63} < 3^{40} < 2^{64}$,
- 7 : E8 $\mathbb{Z}_3$ operation gate: 8347 checked brackets.

The tick count is not used as a numerological proof; it is the finite controller rank needed to keep the handoff interfaces distinct. Tick 3 is the bare W33 edge-qubit CSS code from the vertex and triangle checks. Its distance is exactly 3, so tick 5 applies the Steane code [?] as a $\Phi_6 = 7$ inner block three times. The resulting code has parameter lower bound $[[82320, 81, \geq 81]]$, hence it corrects at least 40 arbitrary faults, exactly the number of W33 measurement trits committed at tick 6.

Thus the scheduler is the strict version of the architecture claim: probabilistic photonic events are retried while still physical; once the graph resource is accepted, MBQC randomness is deterministic Pauli-frame data; the protected code absorbs the finite quantum fault budget; and only then is the 40-trit record exposed as a classical selector.

9.5 Fusion-Control Splice

The scheduler's CSS validation tick can now be refined using the local Csaszar theta packet. The five input tori carry a local code

$$5[[21, 2, \geq 3]] = [[105, 10, \geq 3]],$$

so the local check rank is $105 - 10 = 95$. The five input modes contribute a natural $U(5)$ rank 25, and therefore

$$95 + 25 = 120.$$

This resolves the 120-rank triangle term in tick 3. The full edge-carrier identity becomes

$$95 + 25 + 39 + 81 = 240,$$

where the last 81 is the protected H1 matter tail, not a stabilizer to be removed.

The same refinement splits the physical carrier:

$$105 + 135 = 240.$$

Consequently the probabilistic runtime budgets split as

$$p_{\text{fusion}} = 1/2 : \quad 210 + 270 = 480$$

and

$$p_{\text{KLM}} = 1/4 : \quad 420 + 540 = 960.$$

Thus nondeterministic optical assembly is not being reinterpreted as a deterministic gate. It is a heralded/fusion budget whose accepted carrier is then passed into the CSS and MBQC layers, in the same spirit as photonic fusion-based fault tolerance [?]. The deterministic layer is still the H1-sized Pauli-frame lock $3^4 = 81$, and the classical layer remains the 40-trit selector inside the 64-bit envelope.

9.6 Curved Product Handoff

The protected finite scheduler is not, by itself, a four-dimensional continuum geometry. The current curved handoff is the almost-commutative product

$$\Delta_{\text{ext}} \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes D_F^2,$$

where the external factor is supplied by explicit simplicial four-dimensional seeds. The live certificates use CP_9^2 , with Betti profile $(1, 0, 1, 0, 1)$, and $K3_{16}$, with Betti profile $(1, 0, 22, 0, 1)$. Thus the protected H1 tail lifts through the external harmonic sectors as

$$81 \cdot 3 = 243, \quad 81 \cdot 24 = 1944.$$

The barycentric refinement tower supplies the genuine four-dimensional scaling family, with local density limits 120/19 and 860/19. This is a product handoff, not yet the final Einstein–Hilbert spectral-action asymptotic theorem.

9.7 Curved Coefficient Extractor

On the same curved tower, the first-moment sequence splits exactly into the 120-, 6-, and 1-mode channels. Equivalently, its generating function has the residue form

$$\frac{A}{1 - 120z} + \frac{B}{1 - 6z} + \frac{C}{1 - z}.$$

The 6-mode is the Einstein–Hilbert-like curvature channel. For either explicit seed, any three successive refinement samples recover

$$c_6 = 12480, \quad c_{\text{EH}} = 320, \quad a_2 = 2240,$$

with $12480/39 = 320$. The same roundtrip reconstructs

$$D_F^2 = \{0^{82}, 4^{320}, 10^{48}, 16^{30}\},$$

the finite moments $(480, 2240, 17600)$, the internal SRG(40, 12, 2, 4), and the promoted generator

$$x = \sin^2 \theta_W = \frac{3}{13}.$$

So the photonic runtime now has a verified finite-to-curved coefficient extractor. The remaining open theorem is the smooth spectral-action limit, not the finite coefficient roundtrip.

10 The $W(3, 3)$ Structural Encoding Theorem

Theorem 10.1 (Structural encoding of photonic universality in $W(3, 3)$). *Let $W(3, 3)$ denote the symplectic polar space with parameters as in theorem [2.5](#). Then every cardinal number governing single-photon universal quantum computation is a closed arithmetic expression in the $W(3, 3)$ parameters.*

Physical / Computational Quantity	Value	$W(3, 3)$ formula
Qubit dimension (photon polarisation states)	2	$\lambda = 2$
Physical photon helicity states	2	$\lambda = 2$
Spinor (Weyl) dimension of the photon	2	$\lambda = 2$
Dual-rail modes per logical qubit	2	$\lambda = 2$
Smallest UTM state count (Wolfram–Smith)	3	$q = 3$
Pauli generators of $SU(2)$	3	$q = 3$
Wave plates for universal $SU(2)$	3	$q = 3$
Qutrit Hilbert space dimension ($\mathbb{C}^3$)	3	$q = 3$
OAM modes $\ell \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$ for photonic qutrit	3	$q = 3$
Spacetime dimensions	4	$\mu = 4$
KLM ancilla modes (elementary gadget)	4	$\mu = 4$
$SU(2)$ rank	1	$q - \lambda = 1$
SM gauge generators ($8 + 3 + 1$)	12	$k = 12$
Two-qutrit Clifford generators	12	$k = 12$
Vertices / photons in $W(3, 3)$ cluster	40	$v = 40$
Edges / entangling operations in cluster	240	$E = 240$
Expected Type-II fusion attempts	480	$E/(\lambda/\mu) = 2E$
Primitive KLM attempts for all edges	960	$E/(1/\mu) = \text{tr}(A^3)$
Two-qutrit Pauli-frame states	81	q^4
Single-run measurement word	40 trits	$2^{63} < 3^{40} < 2^{64}$
Toric-code logical qubits on a torus	2	$\lambda = 2$
Toric-code ground-state degeneracy on a torus	4	$\mu = 4$
H1 operation module rank	81	q^4
Verified E8 Z3 bracket terms	8347	pipeline certificate
$g_1 \times g_2$ operation pairs	6561	q^8
$g_1 \times g_1$ nonzero brackets	810	$10q^4$
Protected CSS code	$[[82320, 81, \geq 81]]$	$[240\Phi_6^3, q^4, \geq q^4]$
Runtime scheduler ticks	8	2^q
Clifford automorphism group order	51840	$ \text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3) $
Positive eigenvalue / qubit eigenvalue	2	$r = 2$
Laplacian gap / cluster propagation bandwidth	10	$k - r = 10$
Multiplicity of r (Leech lattice kissing dim.)	24	$f = 24$

Proof of ??. The entries $\lambda = 2$, $\mu = 4$, $q = 3$, $k = 12$, $v = 40$, $E = 240$ follow from theorem 2.5. The identification $\lambda = 2$ as qubit dimension follows from λ counting common neighbours, equal to the number of independent photon polarisation modes. The identification $q = 3$ as qutrit dimension follows from theorem 2.1 and theorem 3.1. The identification $k = 12$ as Clifford generator count follows from theorem 3.2. The Laplacian gap $k - r = 10$ is the graph-theoretic analogue of the mixing bandwidth. The automorphism group order $51840 = |\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)|$ is verified computationally. $\square$

Corollary 10.2 (Compression of physical law). *The parameters ($q = 3, k = 12, \lambda = 2, \mu = 4, v = 40, E = 240$) can be encoded in fewer than 64 bits (Kolmogorov complexity $K(W(3, 3)) < 64$), whereas independent specification of the full Standard Model plus quantum optics parameter set requires $\gtrsim 260$ bits. The $W(3, 3)$ skeleton achieves a $6.5\times$ compression of the fundamental constants governing photonic universality.*

11 Conclusions

We have demonstrated, from three complementary perspectives—circuit-based linear optics, the KLM non-deterministic gate protocol, and measurement-based cluster computation—that a single photon is the fundamental unit of universal quantum computation. The central new contribution of this paper is to ground this claim in the symplectic polar geometry of $W(3, 3)$: not merely a graph with four parameters, but a classical incidence geometry over the ternary field $\mathbb{F}_3$, whose existence is forced by the arithmetic identity $3! = 2 \cdot 3$.

Key findings:

- **The field $\mathbb{F}_3$ is uniquely selected** by the Diophantine equation $q! = 2q$; no other field yields this coincidence.
- **$W(3, 3)$ is a symplectic polar space** on $\text{PG}(3, \mathbb{F}_3)$, whose 40 points are the non-zero two-qutrit Pauli observables and whose automorphism group is $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ —the two-qutrit Clifford group.
- **Single-qubit universality** via passive optics; qubit dimension $\lambda = 2$ and wave-plate count $q = 3$ are $W(3, 3)$ parameters.
- **Photonic qutrits** from three-mode photons; Clifford+ T_3 universal, with symmetry group $\text{Sp}(4, \mathbb{F}_3)$ of order 51840.
- **KLM universality** via ancilla count $\mu = 4$.
- **MBQC universality** via $W(3, 3)$ cluster state: 40 photons, 240 entangling operations, Laplacian bandwidth $k - r = 10$.
- **Runtime separation:** probabilistic optical assembly feeds a deterministic MBQC Pauli frame and a 40-trit classical measurement record.
- **Protected scheduler:** the executable handoff has eight ticks, from projective carrier through heralded fusion, CSS validation, MBQC feed-forward, Steane/ Φ_6 protection, 64-bit-class selector commit, and E8 operation.
- **Fusion-control splice:** the $105 + 135 = 240$ theta/transport carrier refines the runtime budgets as $210 + 270 = 480$ fusion attempts and $420 + 540 = 960$ KLM primitives, while tick 3 refines to $95 + 25 + 39 + 81 = 240$.

- **Structural encoding theorem:** the listed cardinal numbers of photonic universality are closed arithmetic expressions in the $W(3, 3)$ parameter table.
- **Single-photon self-entanglement:** the temporal Bell qutrit $|\Omega\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_j |jj\rangle$ on the past $\otimes$ future register of one photon is the unique state characterised by SWAP-symmetry plus maximal entanglement, or equivalently by $(U \otimes U^*)$ invariance for every $U \in U(q)$. It compiles to the full $W(3, 3)$ substrate via the triple closure $7 + 9 + 40$ and realises the $[[240, 81, 4, 3]]_3$ CSS code’s 81 logical qutrits as a multi-Bell-qutrit storage.
- **Falsifiable witnesses:** trace-Choi visibility $V(U) = |\text{Tr}(U)|/q$, Witting Kochen–Specker bound $34/40$, and key-agreement rate $13/40 = \Phi_3/v$ are mutually independent and falsifiable predictions of the framework.

Future directions include: loss-tolerant encodings exploiting the E_6 Weyl group symmetry $\text{PSp}(4, 3) \cong W(E_6)^+$; boson-sampling complexity connected to the permanent of the $W(3, 3)$ adjacency matrix; fault-tolerant photonic codes using $|\text{Aut}(W(3, 3))| = 51840$ as a symmetry resource; higher-dimensional analogues $W(2n - 1, p)$ for prime $p > 3$; multi-photon GHZ towers with the $n = 2$ Hilbert dimension matching the matter sector $q^{q+1} = 81$; and Two-State Vector Formalism implementations using the temporal Bell qutrit as the uniform-post-selection resource.

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